SENIOR ACTIVITY SERIES

Physical Activity & Movement

Illustrated Activity Workbook

144 Step-by-Step Exercises

6 Activity Categories · 3 Difficulty Levels

Designed for Seniors & Activity Professionals



SECTION 1 OF 6

Seated Cardio

24 exercises

Seated March

OBJECTIVE

Improve cardiovascular circulation and leg mobility through rhythmic seated movement.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright in a sturdy chair with both feet flat on the floor and hands resting on your thighs.
2. Lift your right knee as high as comfortably possible, then lower your foot back to the floor.
3. Alternate with your left knee, finding a steady marching rhythm.
4. Swing your arms gently in sync with your legs — left arm forward with right knee, and vice versa.
5. Continue marching for 2–3 minutes, breathing steadily throughout.

Materials: Sturdy chair with back support · Upbeat music (optional)



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Arm Swings

OBJECTIVE

Warm up the shoulder joints and improve upper-body circulation through controlled rhythmic movement.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright with feet flat on the floor and a comfortable space in front of you.
2. Extend both arms straight out in front at shoulder height.
3. Swing both arms downward together, then back up in a smooth, controlled arc.
4. Keep the movement rhythmic and controlled — avoid swinging too fast.
5. Repeat for 10–15 swings, rest briefly, then repeat 2–3 times.

Materials: No equipment required





Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Chair Cha-Cha

OBJECTIVE

Boost mood and coordination through rhythmic footwork and upper-body movement to music.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall at the edge of your chair with feet flat and arms relaxed at your sides.
2. To the beat, tap your right foot to the right — then bring it back to centre.
3. Tap your left foot to the left — then bring it back to centre (right, centre, left, centre).
4. Add arms: raise your right arm as you tap right, left arm as you tap left.
5. Keep going for 2–3 minutes, following the cha-cha rhythm of the music.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Cha-cha or latin music



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Jumping Jacks

OBJECTIVE

Elevate heart rate and coordinate arm and leg movements for a full seated cardio workout.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright with feet together and arms down by your sides.
2. On the count of 1: tap both feet out to the sides while raising both arms out to shoulder height.
3. On the count of 2: bring feet back together and lower arms back to sides.
4. Build to a steady rhythm — out on 1, in on 2.
5. Continue for 30–60 seconds, rest, then repeat 3 times.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair · Upbeat music



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Heel-Toe Taps

OBJECTIVE

Improve ankle mobility and lower-leg circulation through alternating heel and toe movements.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright with both feet flat on the floor, knees hip-width apart.
2. Lift the toes of your right foot, keeping your heel on the floor (heel tap), then lower.
3. Lift your right heel, keeping your toes on the floor (toe tap), then lower.
4. Repeat with your left foot: heel tap, then toe tap.
5. Alternate between feet, matching the movement to a steady beat for 2–3 minutes.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Rhythmic music (optional)



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Air Cycling

OBJECTIVE

Strengthen hip flexors and improve leg circulation through seated cycling motion.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall at the edge of the chair, hands holding the seat sides for support.
2. Lift both feet slightly off the floor.
3. Begin pedalling in a smooth circular motion — right foot forward and down, left foot back and up.
4. Keep the circles smooth and controlled, not jerky.
5. Pedal forward for 20 seconds, then reverse direction for 20 seconds. Rest and repeat.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Elbow-to-Knee Reach

OBJECTIVE

Activate core muscles and improve rotational mobility through cross-body seated movement.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright with feet flat on the floor and place both hands lightly behind your head.
2. Lift your right knee toward your chest as you twist and bring your left elbow toward that knee.
3. Return to the starting position — back straight, feet flat.
4. Repeat on the other side: lift left knee, twist right elbow toward it.
5. Alternate sides for 8–12 repetitions on each side, breathing steadily.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Boogie



OBJECTIVE

Boost energy, mood and cardiovascular activity through joyful free-form seated dancing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Choose an upbeat favourite song — let participants pick if possible.
2. Sit comfortably with feet flat and start by nodding or tapping to the beat.
3. Add shoulder shimmies, arm waves, clapping, and foot taps as feels natural.
4. Encourage everyone to move freely — there is no right or wrong way.
5. Dance along for the full song (3–4 minutes), resting hands on lap between peaks.

Materials: Speaker · Upbeat favourite music

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Boxing Jabs



OBJECTIVE

Strengthen arms and shoulders while improving cardiovascular fitness through seated punching.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat. Make soft fists, thumbs outside fingers, and hold them at chin height.
2. Extend your right arm forward in a controlled punch, rotating your fist slightly at full extension.
3. Pull it back to chin and immediately punch with your left arm.
4. Build to a steady 4-count rhythm: right, left, right, left.
5. Punch for 30 seconds, rest 15 seconds, then repeat 3–4 rounds.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair · Optional light-weight gloves

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Shoulder Roll March

OBJECTIVE

Coordinate upper and lower body movement to improve circulation and reduce neck tension.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat and arms relaxed at your sides.
2. Begin marching feet alternately at a comfortable pace.
3. While marching, slowly roll both shoulders forward in a large circle.
4. After 4 rolls forward, reverse direction and roll shoulders backward for 4 counts.
5. Continue for 2 minutes, keeping the march rhythm steady throughout.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Upbeat music



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

High-Knee Lift

OBJECTIVE

Strengthen hip flexors and improve balance awareness through exaggerated knee raises.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit toward the edge of the chair with back straight and hands on seat sides for support.
2. Slowly lift your right knee as high as you comfortably can, keeping your back straight.
3. Hold for 2 seconds at the top, then lower your foot to the floor.
4. Repeat with your left knee.
5. Alternate legs for 8–10 repetitions each side, resting if fatigue sets in.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Row

OBJECTIVE

Strengthen upper back and improve posture through a rowing motion that counters forward slumping.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat and extend both arms straight forward at shoulder height, palms facing in.
2. Bend your elbows and pull both arms back, squeezing your shoulder blades together.
3. Hold the squeeze for 2 seconds.
4. Extend arms forward again in a controlled movement to complete one repetition.
5. Perform 3 sets of 12 repetitions, resting 30 seconds between sets.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Optional resistance band



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Finger Drumming

OBJECTIVE

Enhance fine motor coordination and rhythm through sequential finger tapping patterns.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright and rest your hands comfortably on your thighs.
2. Begin tapping all fingers together on your thighs to a steady beat.
3. Try tapping one finger at a time from pinky to index finger, then reverse.
4. Add complexity: tap right hand twice, then left hand twice, alternating.
5. Follow a rhythm the facilitator demonstrates, or create your own pattern for 3–5 minutes.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Drum music or a beat (optional)



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Salsa

OBJECTIVE

Lift mood and improve lateral mobility through salsa-inspired hip and arm movements.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably with feet flat, arms relaxed at your sides.
2. Shift your weight to your right hip, letting your right shoulder dip slightly.
3. Shift your weight to your left hip, allowing your body to sway naturally.
4. Add arms: lift right arm with a wave as you shift right, lift left arm as you shift left.
5. Follow salsa music for 3–4 minutes, keeping movement smooth and enjoyable.

Materials: Chair · Salsa or Latin music



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Clapping Patterns

OBJECTIVE

Build listening skills, rhythm and bilateral coordination through responsive clapping.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably with feet flat and hands in lap ready to clap.
2. The facilitator claps a simple pattern (e.g. clap-clap-pause-clap).
3. Participants echo the pattern back exactly.
4. Increase complexity gradually: add different speeds, pauses or alternating hand-to-thigh beats.
5. Play for 5–10 minutes, letting participants take turns leading the pattern.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Speed Taps

OBJECTIVE

Improve reaction time, lower-leg circulation and cardiovascular rate through rapid foot tapping.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright with feet flat on the floor, hip-width apart.
2. On the signal, begin tapping your feet alternately as quickly as is comfortable.
3. Focus on light, quick taps — heels may stay grounded with just toes lifting.
4. Tap as fast as possible for 20 seconds.
5. Rest for 10 seconds, then repeat 4–6 times, noting if speed improves.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Timer



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Balloon Volleyball



OBJECTIVE

Promote hand–eye coordination, reaction time and upper-body movement in a fun group setting.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Inflate a balloon and seat participants in a circle or across from each other.
2. Tap the balloon gently into the air using open palms — no gripping.
3. Pass the balloon to other participants, encouraging them to keep it off the ground.
4. Count how many taps the group achieves before the balloon touches the floor.
5. Try to beat the previous count each round to add friendly competition.

Materials: 1 inflated balloon per group

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Twist

OBJECTIVE

Improve spinal rotation and release tension in the torso and lower back.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat on the floor, fold both arms across your chest.
2. Slowly rotate your upper body to the right, looking over your right shoulder.
3. Hold for 3 seconds, feeling a gentle stretch along your spine.
4. Return to centre and repeat to the left side.
5. Complete 5 rotations on each side, breathing out as you rotate.

Materials: Sturdy chair with no armrests



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Arm Circles — Forward

OBJECTIVE

Warm up and mobilise the shoulder joints through full circular arm movements.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand or sit tall with feet flat, arms relaxed at your sides.
2. Raise both arms out to the sides at shoulder height.
3. Begin making large forward circles: forward, up, back, down.
4. Keep circles smooth and equal size — avoid shrugging your shoulders.
5. Complete 10 forward circles, then lower your arms and shake them out gently.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Arm Circles — Backward

OBJECTIVE

Counter forward-slump posture by mobilising the shoulders in the opposite direction.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit or stand tall with feet flat, arms out to the sides at shoulder height.
2. Begin making large backward circles: back, up, forward, down.
3. Keep the movement smooth and controlled throughout.
4. Focus on opening the chest as your arms move backward.
5. Complete 10 backward circles, rest, then repeat for a second set.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Seated Kickboxing



OBJECTIVE

Combine upper and lower body movements for a challenging seated cardiovascular routine.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit at the chair edge, feet flat, soft fists at chin height.
2. Begin with 4 jabs: right, left, right, left — keeping core engaged.
3. Add a right kick: extend right leg forward and back, then left leg.
4. Combine: 4 jabs + 2 kicks as one sequence.
5. Perform 3–4 sequences, resting as needed. Stop immediately if any discomfort arises.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair · Ample space in front

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Music Conductor



OBJECTIVE

Engage arms and imagination through expressive conducting movements to classical music.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Choose a piece of classical or orchestral music with a clear beat.
2. Sit tall or stand at a chair, holding a pencil or baton if available.
3. Begin conducting by moving your arm in a steady 4-beat pattern (down, left, right, up).
4. Exaggerate movements: slow sections get slow sweeping gestures; loud sections get big arms.
5. Conduct along for the full piece, 3–5 minutes, letting expressiveness grow.

Materials: Speaker · Classical music · Optional baton or pencil

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Hula

OBJECTIVE

Improve hip mobility and core stability through circular pelvic movements.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit at the edge of your chair with feet flat and hands on hips.
2. Gently roll your hips in a circle to the right — forward, right, back, left.
3. Keep the movement smooth and small to begin with, gradually widening the circle.
4. After 5 circles to the right, reverse direction for 5 circles to the left.
5. Keep your upper body as still as possible, letting movement come only from the hips.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair · Hula or upbeat music



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Standing March



OBJECTIVE

Challenge balance and strengthen legs through upright marching with postural support.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand behind the chair and hold the backrest firmly with both hands.
2. Check posture: feet hip-width apart, shoulders relaxed, gaze forward.
3. Lift your right knee to hip height if possible, hold 1 second, then lower to the floor.
4. Lift your left knee, hold 1 second, then lower.
5. March alternately for 1 minute, resting if needed. Stop if balance feels unsafe.

Materials: Sturdy chair to hold · Non-slip footwear · Clear floor space

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

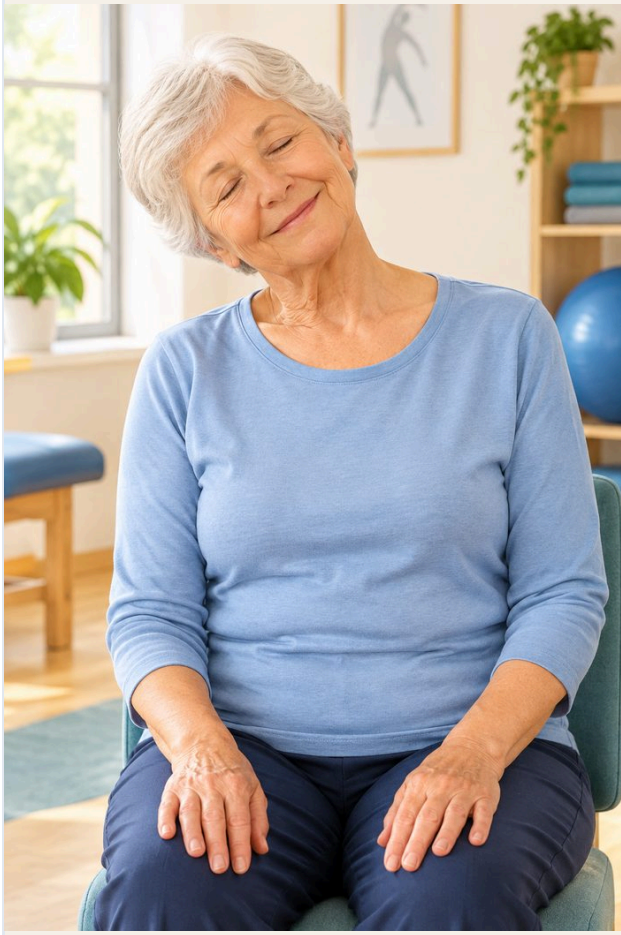


SECTION 2 OF 6

Stretching & Flexibility

24 exercises

Neck Side Stretch



OBJECTIVE

Gently release tension in the neck and upper trapezius muscles, improving range of motion.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with shoulders relaxed and both feet flat on the floor.
2. Slowly tilt your head toward your right shoulder, bringing your ear toward your shoulder.
3. Hold the stretch for 10 seconds, breathing gently — do not force the stretch.
4. Return your head to centre slowly, then repeat on the left side.
5. Complete 3 repetitions on each side, releasing any tension with each exhale.

Materials: No equipment required

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Shoulder Shrug & Release

OBJECTIVE

Release chronic tension in the upper trapezius and neck through exaggerated shrug and drop.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with arms hanging loosely at your sides and feet flat.
2. Breathe in slowly, and raise both shoulders up toward your ears as high as possible.
3. Hold the shrug for 3 seconds — feel the tension build.
4. Breathe out fully and drop your shoulders completely, letting all tension go.
5. Repeat 5 times, noticing how much more relaxed your shoulders feel after each release.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Chest Opener

OBJECTIVE

Stretch the pectoral muscles and improve posture by opening the chest and drawing shoulders back.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit at the edge of your chair with feet flat and back straight.
2. Reach both arms behind you and interlace your fingers behind your lower back.
3. Gently squeeze your shoulder blades together, opening the chest wide.
4. Lift your interlaced hands slightly away from your back to deepen the stretch.
5. Hold for 15–20 seconds, breathe steadily, then release and roll shoulders forward. Repeat 3 times.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Side Reach

OBJECTIVE

Stretch the lateral muscles of the torso and improve side flexibility.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat, one hand resting on your thigh.
2. Raise your right arm overhead, reaching fingers toward the ceiling.
3. Gently lean your body to the left, stretching the right side of your torso.
4. Hold for 10–15 seconds, breathing steadily into the stretch.
5. Return to centre and repeat on the other side. Complete 3 stretches each side.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Forward Bend



OBJECTIVE

Stretch the lower back and hamstrings through a gentle forward hinge from the hips.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall at the chair edge with feet hip-width apart and flat on the floor.
2. Place your hands on your thighs and take a deep breath in.
3. As you breathe out, hinge forward from your hips (not your waist), keeping your back straight.
4. Slide your hands down toward your shins or ankles — only as far as is comfortable.
5. Hold for 15 seconds, then slowly walk your hands back up your legs to return upright.

Materials: Sturdy chair · No armrests preferred

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Ankle Circles

OBJECTIVE

Improve ankle flexibility and circulation in the lower legs through gentle rotation.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall and lift your right foot a few centimetres off the floor.
2. Slowly rotate your right foot clockwise in as large a circle as comfortable.
3. Complete 5 circles clockwise, then 5 circles anticlockwise.
4. Lower your right foot, then repeat with your left foot.
5. Perform the full sequence 3 times on each side, keeping movements slow and controlled.

Materials: Sturdy chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Wrist Circles

OBJECTIVE

Maintain wrist joint mobility and improve circulation in the hands and forearms.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably and extend both arms in front of you, elbows slightly bent.
2. Make loose fists with both hands.
3. Slowly rotate both wrists clockwise in large, smooth circles simultaneously.
4. After 5 circles, reverse direction and rotate anticlockwise for 5 circles.
5. Open and close your fingers several times to finish. Repeat the sequence 3 times.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Cat-Cow Seated



OBJECTIVE

Mobilise the entire spine and improve breathing capacity through rhythmic spinal flexion and extension.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit at the chair edge with feet flat and hands resting on your knees.
2. Breathe in and arch your back: chest forward, shoulders back, look slightly upward (Cow).
3. Breathe out and round your spine: tuck your chin, curl your back, draw navel inward (Cat).
4. Move fluidly between the two positions, letting your breath lead the movement.
5. Continue for 8–10 slow breath cycles, increasing the range of motion gently over time.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Hip Flexor Stretch



OBJECTIVE

Lengthen the hip flexor muscles that tighten from prolonged sitting, reducing lower back strain.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit at the very edge of the chair with feet flat on the floor.
2. Slide your right foot backward until your right knee approaches the floor.
3. Keep your torso upright and gently press your hips forward to feel a stretch at the front of your right hip.
4. Hold for 20–30 seconds, breathing steadily.
5. Slide your right foot back to start, then repeat on the left side. Do 2–3 repetitions each.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Non-slip floor surface

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Quad Stretch

OBJECTIVE

Stretch the quadricep muscles to relieve knee stiffness and improve standing ease.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall near the front of the chair with feet flat and posture upright.
2. Reach back with your right hand and grasp your right ankle or trouser leg.
3. Gently pull your right heel toward the seat of the chair until you feel a stretch in the front of your thigh.
4. Hold for 20 seconds, keeping your back straight and both knees close together.
5. Release slowly and repeat on the left side. Perform 2–3 repetitions each leg.

Materials: Sturdy chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Calf Raise Stretch

OBJECTIVE

Strengthen calves and stretch the Achilles tendon to support walking and standing stability.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand behind the chair holding the backrest, or sit tall at the edge.
2. Raise both heels off the floor, coming up onto the balls of your feet.
3. Hold the raised position for 2 seconds.
4. Lower your heels slowly back to the floor, feeling a gentle stretch in your calves.
5. Repeat 10–15 times, rest briefly, then complete 2 more sets.

Materials: Sturdy chair for support



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Spinal Twist

OBJECTIVE

Improve thoracic spine rotation and relieve tension from prolonged sitting.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall at the edge of the chair with feet flat and arms crossed over your chest.
2. Take a deep breath in, lengthening your spine.
3. Breathe out and rotate your entire upper body to the right, looking over your right shoulder.
4. Hold for 5 long breaths, maintaining the upright position.
5. Breathe in to return to centre, then repeat on the left side. Do 3 twists per side.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Neck Forward Tilt

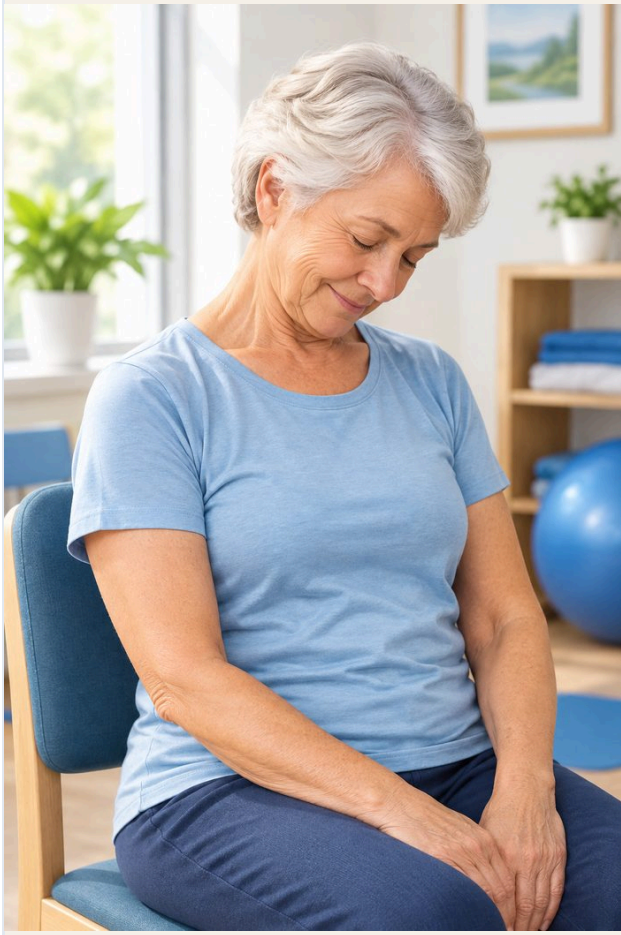
OBJECTIVE

Stretch the posterior neck muscles and relieve tension at the base of the skull.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with shoulders relaxed and arms resting gently in your lap.
2. Breathe in, and as you breathe out, slowly tuck your chin toward your chest.
3. You should feel a gentle stretch at the back of your neck — do not press down.
4. Hold for 10 seconds, breathing softly.
5. Slowly lift your head back to neutral. Rest 5 seconds, then repeat 4–5 times.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Finger Splay

OBJECTIVE

Maintain finger joint mobility and improve hand grip through repeated spread and squeeze.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Hold both hands out in front of you, palms facing down, fingers together.
2. Spread all fingers as wide apart as possible — hold for 5 seconds.
3. Close your hands slowly into gentle fists — hold for 5 seconds.
4. Open your hands flat again, pressing fingers straight.
5. Repeat the open-close sequence 10 times, moving smoothly between positions.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Thumb Circles

OBJECTIVE

Improve thumb mobility and reduce stiffness from arthritis through gentle circular movement.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Hold both hands out with palms up, fingers relaxed and slightly curled.
2. Begin rotating your right thumb in large clockwise circles.
3. After 5 circles, reverse direction for 5 anticlockwise circles.
4. Repeat the same sequence with your left thumb.
5. Do 3 full rounds on each hand. Move slowly and stop if any sharp pain is felt.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Ear-to-Shoulder Stretch

OBJECTIVE

Relieve tension in the lateral neck and upper shoulder muscles through assisted side stretch.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with both feet flat and spine long.
2. Tilt your head toward your right shoulder, bringing your right ear down toward it.
3. Place your right hand gently on top of your head — do not pull, just allow gravity to deepen the stretch.
4. Hold for 15 seconds, breathing slowly. Feel the stretch on the left side of your neck.
5. Lift your head back to centre, then repeat on the left side. Do 3 stretches per side.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Upper Back Press



OBJECTIVE

Stretch the rhomboids and upper back muscles to relieve tension from forward posture.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall and extend both arms straight in front of you at shoulder height.
2. Interlace your fingers, palms facing away from you.
3. Push your hands forward while rounding your upper back — tuck your chin slightly.
4. Feel the stretch between your shoulder blades.
5. Hold for 15 seconds, breathing into the stretch, then release. Repeat 4–5 times.

Materials: No equipment required

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Hamstring Towel Stretch



OBJECTIVE

Lengthen the hamstring muscles to improve hip hinge movement and reduce lower back tension.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit at the chair edge with a towel or resistance band in hand.
2. Loop the towel around the sole of your right foot.
3. Hold both ends of the towel and gently straighten your right leg until you feel a stretch in the back of your thigh.
4. Hold for 20–30 seconds, keeping your back straight.
5. Bend the knee, lower the foot, and repeat on the left side. Do 3 repetitions per leg.

Materials: Towel or resistance band · Sturdy chair

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Hip Circle

OBJECTIVE

Lubricate the hip joints and improve lumbar mobility through gentle pelvic rotation.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit at the chair edge with feet flat and hands on your hips.
2. Begin circling your hips slowly to the right in a smooth oval or circle.
3. Keep your upper body as still as possible — let movement come from the pelvis.
4. Complete 8 circles to the right, then reverse for 8 circles to the left.
5. Rest and repeat once more. Increase the size of the circles gradually as you warm up.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Wrist Flexor Stretch

OBJECTIVE

Stretch the forearm flexor muscles to relieve tension from typing, gripping or arthritis.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall and extend your right arm in front of you, palm facing up.
2. With your left hand, gently bend your right wrist back so fingers point toward the floor.
3. Hold for 15 seconds — feel the stretch along the inside of your forearm.
4. Release and repeat with the palm facing down (dorsal stretch).
5. Switch arms and repeat both stretches. Complete 3 rounds per wrist.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Forearm Roll

OBJECTIVE

Relieve forearm muscle tension and improve circulation using gentle pressure massage.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably with a smooth cylindrical object (foam roller or bottle) on a table.
2. Place your right forearm on top of the roller, palm facing down.
3. Apply gentle downward pressure and slowly roll the roller from your wrist to your elbow.
4. Roll back and forth for 30 seconds, adjusting pressure to suit comfort.
5. Switch to your left forearm and repeat. Avoid rolling directly on a bony area.

Materials: Foam roller or smooth water bottle · Table



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Lower Back Tilt

OBJECTIVE

Mobilise the lumbar spine and relieve lower back stiffness through gentle pelvic tilting.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall at the chair edge with feet flat, hands resting on thighs.
2. Tilt your pelvis forward, arching your lower back and lifting your tailbone slightly (anterior tilt).
3. Then tilt your pelvis backward, flattening or rounding your lower back (posterior tilt).
4. Rock gently between the two positions in a slow rhythm.
5. Continue for 10–15 repetitions, breathing freely and keeping movement smooth.

Materials: Sturdy armless chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Full-Body Wake-Up

OBJECTIVE

Gently awaken the whole body through a quick head-to-toe mobilisation sequence.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall and begin with 5 slow neck rolls: right ear to shoulder, chin to chest, left ear, back to start.
2. Roll both shoulders forward 5 times, then backward 5 times.
3. Circle both wrists 5 times each direction.
4. Lift each foot and circle both ankles 5 times each direction.
5. Finish with 3 deep belly breaths: inhale for 4 counts, exhale for 6 counts.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Towel Back Scratch

OBJECTIVE

Improve shoulder internal and external rotation range through an assisted behind-the-back stretch.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall and hold one end of a small towel in your right hand.
2. Raise your right arm overhead and let the towel fall down your back.
3. Reach your left hand behind and below to grasp the other end of the towel.
4. Gently pull down with your left hand to stretch your right shoulder overhead.
5. Hold for 15 seconds, then slowly switch: left arm up, right arm down. Repeat 3 times each.

Materials: Small hand towel



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.



SECTION 3 OF 6

Balance & Coordination

24 exercises

Weight Shift

OBJECTIVE

Improve lateral balance control and proprioception while standing safely.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand behind the chair, holding the backrest with both hands.
2. Shift your body weight slowly to your right foot, lifting your left heel slightly.
3. Hold the right-side balance for 3 seconds.
4. Slowly shift all your weight to your left foot, lifting your right heel.
5. Continue shifting side to side for 10 repetitions each side, keeping movements slow and controlled.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Non-slip footwear



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Single Leg Stand

OBJECTIVE

Challenge static balance and strengthen the ankle and hip stabilisers.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand behind the chair and hold the backrest lightly with fingertips only.
2. Shift your weight onto your right foot and slowly lift your left foot a few centimetres off the floor.
3. Stand on your right leg for up to 10 seconds, keeping your gaze fixed on a point ahead.
4. Lower your left foot gently, rest, then repeat on the right leg.
5. Build up to 3 repetitions per side. Always keep one hand ready to grip the chair.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Non-slip footwear · Clear floor space



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Tandem Stance



OBJECTIVE

Improve narrow-base balance to simulate the balance demands of walking.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand behind the chair and hold the backrest.
2. Place your right foot directly in front of your left foot, heel touching toes.
3. Release the chair slowly, keeping fingers lightly ready to catch.
4. Hold the tandem position for 10–30 seconds, focusing on a fixed point ahead.
5. Swap feet (left foot forward) and repeat. Build up to 3 holds each way.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Non-slip footwear

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Heel-Toe Walk



OBJECTIVE

Improve dynamic balance and gait control through narrow-base walking.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Clear a straight path of at least 3 metres.
2. Stand at one end and place your arms out to the sides for balance.
3. Place your right heel directly in front of your left toes so they are touching.
4. Then place your left heel directly in front of your right toes.
5. Walk 10 steps in this heel-to-toe fashion, turn carefully, and walk back. Repeat 3 times.

Materials: Clear floor space · Non-slip footwear

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Tightrope Walk



OBJECTIVE

Simulate narrow-base walking balance on a visible line to reduce fall risk.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a strip of masking tape in a straight line across a clear area of floor.
2. Stand at one end of the line with arms outstretched to the sides.
3. Walk heel-to-toe along the tape for its full length.
4. At the end, pause, turn slowly and walk back.
5. Complete 3–4 passes of the tightrope, stepping off if balance feels unsafe.

Materials: Masking tape · Clear floor space · Non-slip footwear

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Cone Weave



OBJECTIVE

Improve dynamic balance, spatial awareness and multidirectional movement control.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set up 5 cones or objects in a straight line, 50 cm apart.
2. Stand at one end and prepare to walk — use a walking aid if needed.
3. Walk around each cone, alternating left and right through the course.
4. Reach the end of the course, pause, then weave back through the cones.
5. Complete 3 passes. Reduce cone spacing to increase difficulty over time.

Materials: 5 cones or cups · Clear floor space · Non-slip footwear

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Bean Bag Balance

OBJECTIVE

Challenge upright posture and improve proprioception by carrying weight on the hand.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a small bean bag on the back of your right hand.
2. Stand or sit upright and attempt to keep the bean bag balanced without holding it.
3. Slowly extend your arm forward, then to the side, trying to maintain balance.
4. Walk slowly for 5 metres, keeping the bean bag in place.
5. Swap to your left hand and repeat. Try to complete 3 passes without dropping the bag.

Materials: Small bean bag · Clear path



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Catching Practice

OBJECTIVE

Improve hand–eye coordination and reaction speed through progressive throwing and catching.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit or stand facing a partner at an arm's length distance.
2. The partner gently underarms a foam ball directly to the participant.
3. Catch the ball with both hands and toss it gently back.
4. Gradually increase the throwing distance by 30 cm each round.
5. Continue for 5 minutes. If the ball is missed, return to the previous distance.

Materials: Soft foam ball per pair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Throwing Accuracy

OBJECTIVE

Build fine motor control and spatial awareness through targeted underarm throwing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place 3–4 hula hoops or target rings flat on the floor at 1, 1.5 and 2 metres.
2. Give each participant 5 beanbags.
3. Throw each beanbag underarm, aiming for the nearest target first.
4. Score 1 point for each beanbag that lands in a ring.
5. Take turns and record scores. Challenge participants to beat their own score next round.

Materials: 4 beanbags per person · 3 hula hoops or taped targets



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Ball Bounce & Catch

OBJECTIVE

Develop unilateral hand control and eye-tracking through controlled ball bouncing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit or stand with a medium rubber ball in your right hand.
2. Bounce the ball on the floor with moderate force, using your right hand.
3. Let it rise and catch it with your right hand.
4. After 5 successful catches, switch to your left hand.
5. Advance to bouncing with the right hand and catching with the left — 10 repetitions each pattern.

Materials: Medium rubber ball per participant



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Noodle Push

OBJECTIVE

Promote bilateral upper-body coordination in a fun, low-resistance activity.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit facing a partner with a foam pool noodle held between you horizontally.
2. Each person holds one end with both hands.
3. Gently push your end of the noodle forward while your partner resists lightly.
4. Alternate pushing and resisting in a smooth rhythm for 30 seconds.
5. Swap to holding the noodle vertically and repeat — this changes the muscle groups used.

Materials: 1 foam pool noodle per pair · Chairs



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Floor Target Kick

OBJECTIVE

Improve lower-limb control and seated hip extension through targeted kicking.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall at the chair edge, feet flat, with a target mat or taped square on the floor 50 cm ahead.
2. Lift your right foot and extend your leg to push or kick a rolled foam ball toward the target.
3. Retrieve the ball (with help if needed) and repeat with your left foot.
4. Alternate feet for 10 kicks each side.
5. Move the target further away or make it smaller to increase difficulty progressively.

Materials: Foam ball · Target mat or taped square on floor · Chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Step-Tap Balance

OBJECTIVE

Build lateral dynamic balance and hip abductor strength through rhythmic side steps.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand behind the chair, holding the backrest lightly.
2. Step your right foot out to the right and tap it on the floor.
3. Bring your right foot back to centre, transferring your weight.
4. Repeat to the left: step left foot out, tap, return to centre.
5. Continue side-tapping for 1 minute, then rest. Perform 3 sets, increasing speed gradually.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Non-slip footwear



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Obstacle Course

OBJECTIVE

Improve multidirectional gait, spatial awareness and confidence in a safe environment.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set up a simple course: walk around 2 chairs, step over a pool noodle, walk through 4 cones.
2. Brief participants on the route and demonstrate it once.
3. Participants walk through the course at their own pace, using a walking aid if needed.
4. A facilitator walks alongside for safety — never ahead.
5. Complete 2–3 passes, noting improvements in speed and confidence.

Materials: 2 chairs · 1 pool noodle · 4 cones · Walking aids if needed



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Standing Side Leg Raise

OBJECTIVE

Strengthen hip abductors and improve lateral stability for safer walking and stair use.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand beside the chair and hold the backrest with your right hand.
2. Stand tall: shoulders relaxed, core gently engaged, weight on your right foot.
3. Slowly lift your left leg straight out to the side — no higher than hip height.
4. Hold for 2 seconds, then slowly lower.
5. Complete 10 repetitions, then switch sides. Perform 2–3 sets per side.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Non-slip footwear



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Marching With Eyes Closed

OBJECTIVE

Challenge the vestibular system and improve proprioceptive balance control.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand in a clear area near a wall or chair for safety.
2. Begin marching in place with eyes open to establish your position.
3. Gently close your eyes and continue marching in place for 20 steps.
4. Open your eyes and check how far you have drifted from your starting position.
5. Repeat 3 times, aiming to stay closer to the start position each time. Always have a spotter nearby.

Materials: Clear floor space · Wall or chair nearby · Spotter



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Wall Push-Up

OBJECTIVE

Build upper-body pushing strength and improve scapular stability in a safe standing position.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand facing a clear wall, arm's length away. Place both palms flat on the wall at shoulder height.
2. Walk feet back until arms are straight and body forms a diagonal plank.
3. Bend both elbows to lower your chest toward the wall, keeping the body straight.
4. Push through your palms to straighten your arms and return to start.
5. Repeat 10–15 times for 3 sets, resting between sets. Keep core engaged throughout.

Materials: Clear wall space · Non-slip footwear



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Tray Carry Walk

OBJECTIVE

Improve functional balance and postural control in a task-relevant walking activity.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place 2–3 light objects (cups, blocks) on a lightweight tray.
2. Hold the tray level with both hands and stand at one end of a clear walkway.
3. Walk slowly the length of the walkway (3–5 metres), keeping the tray stable.
4. Pause, turn carefully, then return.
5. Complete 3 passes. Increase challenge by adding more objects or narrowing the path.

Materials: Lightweight tray · 2–3 light objects · Clear walkway



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Foam Pad Stand

OBJECTIVE

Increase balance challenge by reducing the stability of the standing surface.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a foam balance pad (or folded towel) on the floor behind a sturdy chair.
2. Hold the chair backrest and step onto the foam pad with both feet.
3. Once stable, reduce grip to fingertips only.
4. Hold the balance for 20–30 seconds, focusing on a fixed point ahead.
5. Step off carefully. Rest and repeat 3–5 times. Stop immediately if you feel unsafe.

Materials: Foam balance pad or folded non-slip towel · Sturdy chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Gait Belt Walk

OBJECTIVE

Practise safe ambulation with tactile cueing to improve confidence and stride length.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Fit a gait belt securely around the participant's waist — snug but comfortable.
2. The facilitator stands to the side and slightly behind, holding the belt firmly.
3. Ask the participant to walk at their comfortable pace along a clear corridor.
4. Count steps aloud together to encourage rhythm and stride awareness.
5. Walk for 2–3 minutes, turning with care. Adjust pace and support as needed.

Materials: Gait belt · Clear corridor · Non-slip footwear



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Crossed Arm Balance

OBJECTIVE

Challenge postural control by removing arm-swing compensation during weight shifting.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand behind the chair holding the backrest. Cross both arms over your chest.
2. Release the chair — arms remain crossed, no hand support.
3. Hold still for 10 seconds, focusing on a fixed point.
4. Carefully shift weight to your right foot for 5 seconds, then to your left.
5. Rest if needed and repeat 3 times. Have a spotter nearby.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Spotter



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Step-Up Practice



OBJECTIVE

Strengthen quadriceps and improve confidence and technique for stair use.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a low, non-slip riser (10–15 cm) next to a sturdy railing or wall.
2. Stand facing the step and hold the railing with one hand.
3. Step up with your right foot, pressing through the heel to raise yourself up.
4. Bring your left foot up to meet your right on the step.
5. Step down right foot first, then left. Complete 5 repetitions, then lead with the left foot.

Materials: Low non-slip riser or step · Sturdy railing · Non-slip footwear

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Coordination Ladder



OBJECTIVE

Improve foot placement accuracy, gait agility and cognitive-motor coordination.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay a flat coordination ladder (or tape squares) on a clear floor.
2. Brief the participant on the stepping pattern: both feet in each box, one at a time.
3. Walk through the ladder slowly and carefully, stepping into each box.
4. Rest at the end, turn slowly, and walk back through with a different pattern.
5. Complete 3 passes. Increase pace or add arm movements once comfortable.

Materials: Coordination ladder or taped squares · Non-slip footwear · Spotter

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Standing Reach





OBJECTIVE

Improve upper-limb reaching in multiple directions while maintaining standing balance.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Stand behind the chair and let go of the backrest, feet hip-width apart.
2. Reach both arms forward as far as possible without stepping or bending at the waist.
3. Hold for 3 seconds, then return to neutral.
4. Reach both arms out to the right, hold 3 seconds, return to neutral.
5. Reach to the left and hold. Repeat each direction 5 times. Have chair ready to grip.

Materials: Sturdy chair · Non-slip footwear · Clear space

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.



SECTION 4 OF 6

Fine Motor Skills

24 exercises

Peg Board

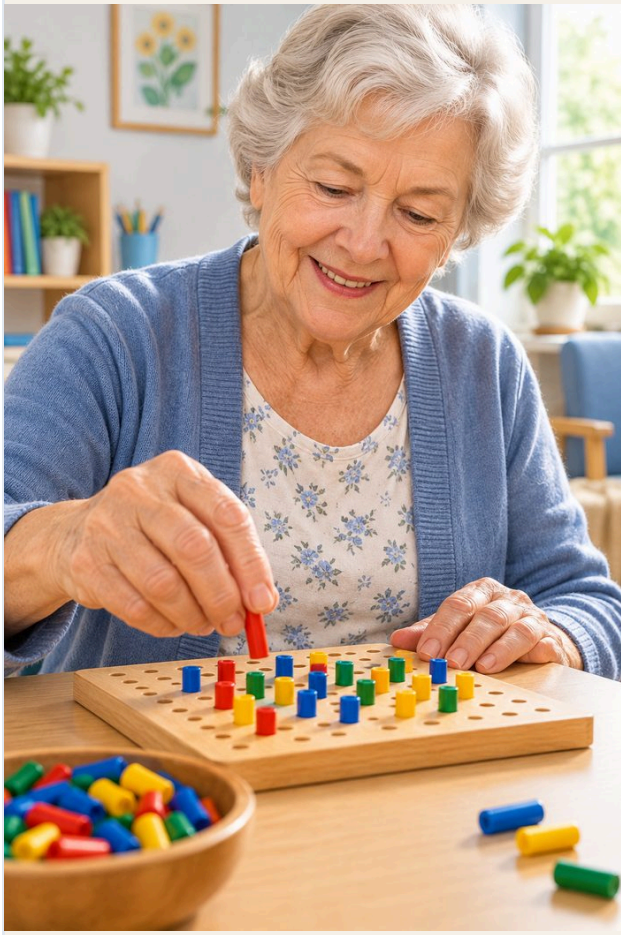
OBJECTIVE

Improve manual dexterity and visual–motor coordination through precise peg placement.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place the pegboard on a table with a cup of coloured pegs beside it.
2. Show the participant the target pattern using a picture card or demonstration.
3. Pick up one peg at a time using a pincer grip (thumb and index finger).
4. Insert each peg firmly into its matching hole.
5. Complete the pattern, then remove all pegs one at a time and try a new pattern.

Materials: Pegboard with coloured pegs · Pattern reference cards



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Lacing Cards



OBJECTIVE

Practise grip, bilateral hand coordination and sequencing through lacing movements.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay a large lacing card on the table with the lace threaded through the starting hole.
2. Pick up the loose end of the lace with your dominant hand.
3. Thread the lace through the next hole from front to back.
4. Pull the lace through fully with your other hand to assist.
5. Continue threading through each hole in sequence until the pattern is complete.

Materials: Large lacing cards with pre-threaded cord · Table

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Button & Unbutton

OBJECTIVE

Maintain and improve the fine motor skill needed for daily dressing and independence.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place the large-button practice board flat on a table.
2. Start by unfastening all buttons: pinch the button with your dominant thumb and index finger, ease it through the buttonhole.
3. Once all buttons are undone, refasten from top to bottom.
4. To fasten: push the button halfway through the hole with your dominant hand, then pull it the rest of the way through with your other hand.
5. Repeat the sequence 3 times, increasing speed gradually as dexterity improves.

Materials: Large-button practice board or shirt



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Zip Practise

OBJECTIVE

Maintain independence with clothing by practising zip fastening in different orientations.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set the zip practice board on a table or prop it vertically.
2. Insert the zip slider tab onto the zip base — pinch tab and base together.
3. Grip the tab firmly between thumb and index finger and pull upward to close.
4. Pull the tab downward to open. Repeat on all three zip sizes if available.
5. Time yourself on one zip and aim to improve your time each session.

Materials: Zip practice board (various zip sizes) · Table or easel



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Coin Slot Drop

OBJECTIVE

Develop precision grip and release by threading coins through a narrow slot.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a box with a slot cut in the lid on the table with a pile of coins beside it.
2. Pick up one coin using a pincer grip — thumb and index finger.
3. Hold the coin upright and align it with the slot.
4. Release the coin through the slot cleanly.
5. Continue until all coins are in the box, then turn the box over and repeat. Try to increase your speed each round.

Materials: Box with coin slot in lid · A handful of coins



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Bead Threading

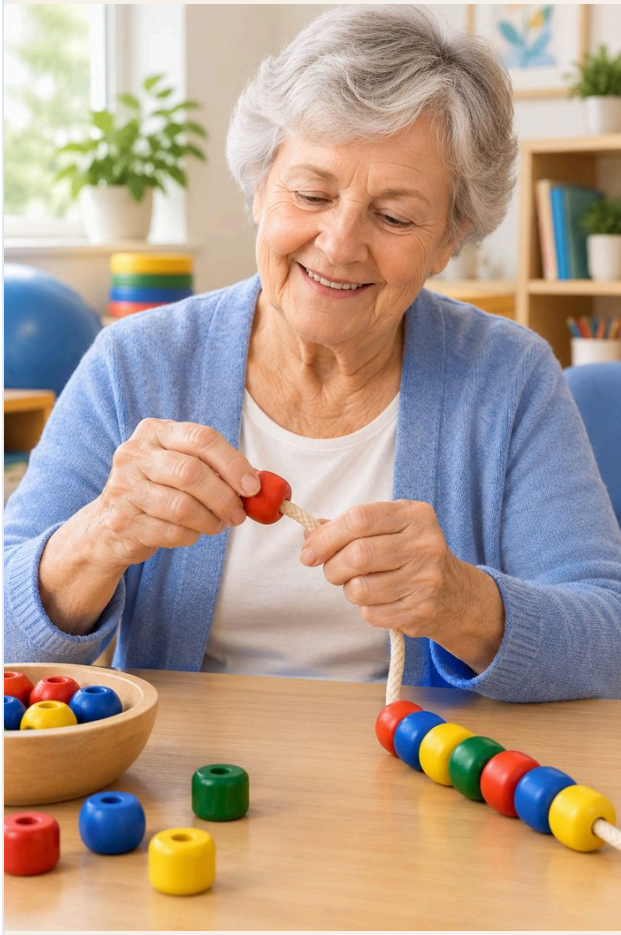
OBJECTIVE

Improve bilateral coordination and sequencing through precise bead placement on a cord.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a cord with a stiff end (or laced with a needle) on the table with large beads.
2. Lay out the colour sequence to copy: e.g. red, blue, yellow, green.
3. Pick up the first bead (red) with your dominant hand and hold the cord end with the other.
4. Thread the bead onto the cord and slide it down.
5. Continue threading in the correct colour sequence until the cord is full. Tip the beads off and restart with a new pattern.

Materials: Large wooden beads in 4 colours · Thick cord with stiffened tip



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Paper Folding



OBJECTIVE

Strengthen hand coordination, precision and sequential planning through structured origami.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a square sheet of paper on a table.
2. Fold the paper in half horizontally, aligning the edges carefully.
3. Press along the fold firmly with your thumb to create a sharp crease.
4. Open, then fold diagonally: corner to corner, crease firmly.
5. Follow the next step of the chosen origami pattern. Keep movements slow and precise.

Materials: Square origami paper · Step-by-step picture guide

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Scissor Practice

OBJECTIVE

Maintain hand strength and cutting precision through structured scissor activities.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a scissor practice card on the table. Choose a beginner card with straight lines first.
2. Insert the dominant thumb in the top ring and two fingers in the lower ring of the scissors.
3. Position the scissors at the starting line edge.
4. Open and close the scissors in a steady rhythm, guiding along the line.
5. Advance to curved lines once straight lines can be cut accurately. Check cut quality after each card.

Materials: Safety scissors · Scissor practice cards (straight then curved lines)



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Nut and Bolt Fastening

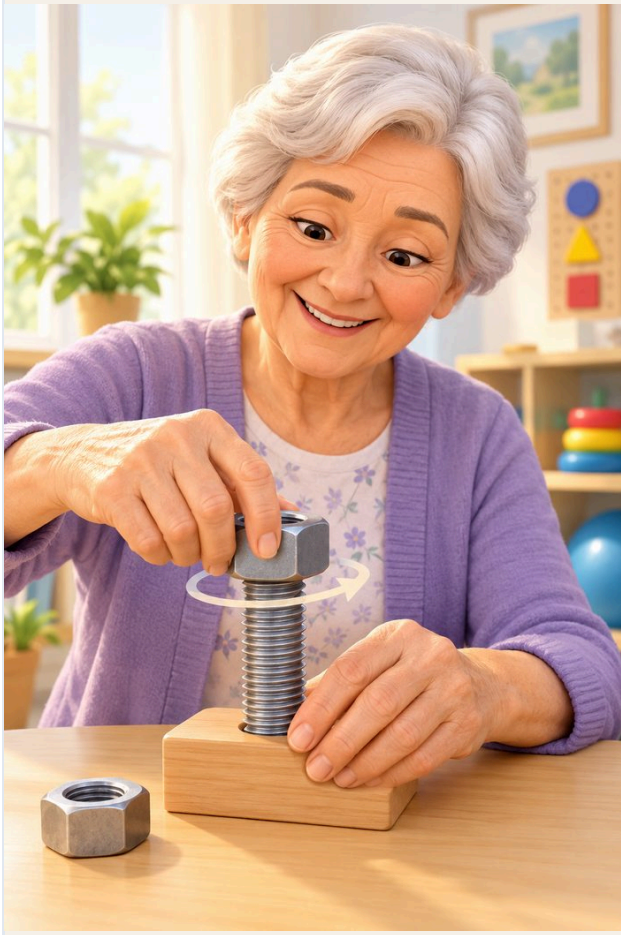
OBJECTIVE

Strengthen the hand and finger muscles used in daily gripping through resisted turning.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay 4–6 bolts with matching nuts on the table.
2. Hold a bolt steady with your non-dominant hand.
3. Pick up the matching nut and begin threading it onto the bolt with your dominant hand.
4. Turn the nut clockwise to tighten it as far as it will go.
5. Unscrew the nut anticlockwise and set both aside. Move on to the next size. Complete all sizes, then repeat in reverse order.

Materials: 4–6 bolts with matching nuts of varying sizes



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Pincer Grip Sorting

OBJECTIVE

Strengthen the pincer grip and improve object control through categorised sorting with tongs.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set out 3 bowls labelled by colour or category and a mixed pile of small objects in a central bowl.
2. Give the participant kitchen or craft tongs.
3. Pick up one object at a time using the tongs — no fingers allowed.
4. Place the object in its matching bowl.
5. Complete the full sort, then mix the objects and repeat, aiming for speed and accuracy.

Materials: Kitchen or craft tongs · 4 bowls · Mixed small objects (cubes, marbles, etc.)



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★ Independent

Putty Squeezing

OBJECTIVE

Strengthen hand and finger flexor muscles to improve grip strength for daily activities.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Warm the therapy putty between your palms for 30 seconds.
2. Form the putty into a ball and place it in your right palm.
3. Squeeze the putty as hard as comfortably possible, hold for 3 seconds, then release.
4. Roll the putty into a long sausage shape, then roll it back into a ball.
5. Continue squeezing and reshaping for 5 minutes. Swap to your left hand and repeat.

Materials: Therapy putty (light to medium resistance)



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Card Shuffling

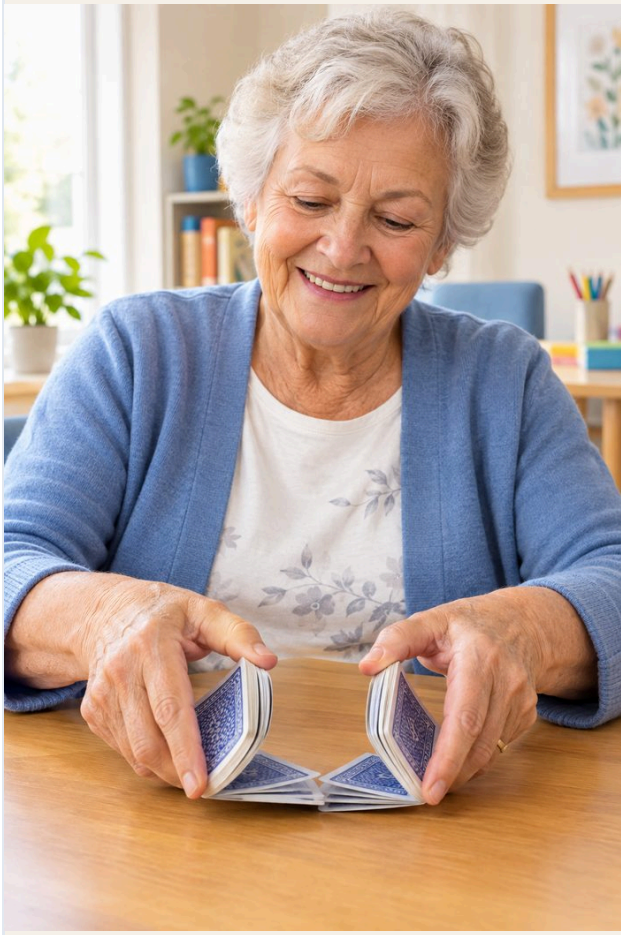
OBJECTIVE

Improve bilateral hand coordination and fine motor dexterity through card handling.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Hold a standard deck of cards face-down in your dominant hand.
2. Split the deck roughly in half and hold each half in one hand.
3. Bring both halves together and riffle the edges with your thumbs, letting cards interleave.
4. Push the two halves together to complete the shuffle.
5. Perform 5 shuffles, then deal the cards into 4 equal piles one card at a time.

Materials: Standard deck of cards



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Coin Sorting

OBJECTIVE

Improve tactile discrimination, fine motor precision and visual–spatial processing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Mix a handful of different coin denominations in a pile on the table.
2. Group the coins by denomination using only your fingers — no scooping.
3. Pick up each coin with a pincer grip and place it in its group.
4. Stack each group into a neat pile of 5, pressing down with your index finger to align.
5. Record how many coins you sorted correctly and aim to improve speed each session.

Materials: Mixed coins · Table mat



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Rubber-Band Stretching



OBJECTIVE

Strengthen finger extensor muscles (often neglected) through resisted opening movements.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a pegboard with 8 pegs set in two rows of 4 on the table.
2. Loop one rubber band around two pegs to form the starting pattern shown on the reference card.
3. Using one finger and thumb, stretch and loop further bands to reproduce the pattern.
4. Once the pattern is complete, photograph or admire it, then remove bands one at a time.
5. Try a new, more complex pattern. This exercise specifically targets finger-opening strength.

Materials: Pegboard with pegs · Assorted rubber bands · Pattern reference cards

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Pom-Pom Tweezers



OBJECTIVE

Refine precision grip control through the transfer of lightweight objects using craft tweezers.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set two bowls on the table 20 cm apart. Fill the left bowl with coloured pom-poms.
2. Pick up one pom-pom using craft tweezers — pinch gently so it does not shoot away.
3. Move it to the right bowl without dropping.
4. Continue transferring all pom-poms, one at a time.
5. Reverse the task: transfer all pom-poms back to the left bowl. Time both transfers and compare.

Materials: Craft tweezers · 2 bowls · 20 coloured pom-poms

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Cup Stacking

OBJECTIVE

Develop bimanual coordination and spatial planning through timed cup pyramid construction.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place 10 paper cups in a pile on the table.
2. Stack the cups into a pyramid: 4 on the bottom, then 3, then 2, then 1 on top.
3. Move the cups one at a time — each hand may only move one cup at a time.
4. Once the pyramid is complete, disassemble it into a single stack in reverse order.
5. Time yourself and try to beat your record. Increase to 15 cups for a greater challenge.

Materials: 10–15 paper or plastic cups · Table · Timer



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Marble Run Assembly



OBJECTIVE

Challenge bilateral coordination and spatial reasoning through construction and marble guiding.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay out the marble run components on the table in a mixed pile.
2. Choose a simple track pattern from the reference sheet.
3. Pick up each piece and slot it into the track support frame using both hands.
4. Once the track is assembled, test it by releasing a marble at the top.
5. Adjust any pieces that caused the marble to stop, then disassemble and try a new pattern.

Materials: Plastic marble run kit · Reference pattern sheet

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Lock & Key Practice

OBJECTIVE

Maintain the hand strength and precision needed for independent key and lock use.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place 3 padlocks (varying types: key, combination, lever) on the table with their keys.
2. For the key lock: insert the correct key — feel the ridges align with the lock pins.
3. Turn the key clockwise until the shackle pops open.
4. Lock it again by closing the shackle and turning anticlockwise.
5. Work through all 3 lock types, then shuffle the keys and repeat without labels.

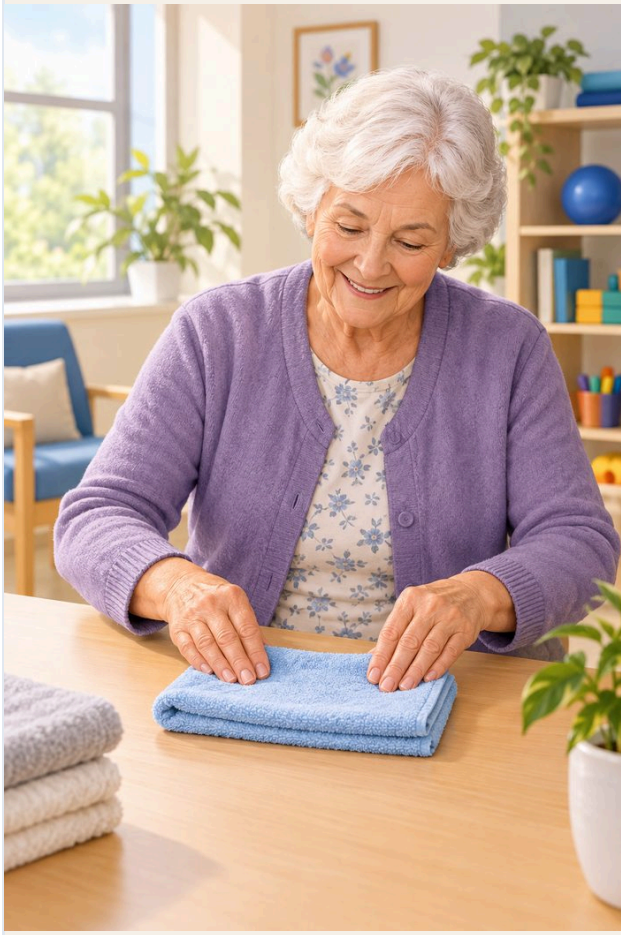
Materials: 3 different padlocks with keys · Table



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★ Independent

Cloth Folding



OBJECTIVE

Practise daily self-care skills and bilateral coordination through structured folding tasks.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay a small hand towel flat on the table.
2. Fold it in half, bringing the top edge down to the bottom — press the fold with your palm.
3. Fold in half again from left to right — press the fold firmly.
4. Shake the towel out and re-fold it in thirds instead: fold left third to centre, then right third over.
5. Repeat the whole sequence with a t-shirt and a scarf. Aim for neat, aligned folds.

Materials: Small towel · T-shirt · Scarf · Table

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★ Independent

Handwriting Tracing

OBJECTIVE

Maintain hand control and grip for writing through guided letter and shape tracing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a tracing sheet with large dotted letters or shapes on the table.
2. Hold a thick felt-tip pen in your dominant hand using a tripod grip.
3. Begin at the starting dot indicated on the first letter.
4. Trace slowly and steadily along the dotted outline — try not to lift the pen.
5. Complete one line at a time, pausing to relax your hand grip every 3–4 letters.

Materials: Large dotted tracing sheets · Thick felt-tip pen · Table



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★ Independent

Dot-to-Dot Pencil

OBJECTIVE

Improve hand–eye coordination and number recognition through sequenced pencil work.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a numbered dot-to-dot sheet on the table and give the participant a pencil.
2. Find dot number 1 and place the pencil tip on it.
3. Draw a straight line to dot number 2, keeping the pencil on the paper.
4. Continue connecting the dots in order, lifting the pencil briefly between dots if needed.
5. When all dots are connected, colour the finished picture. Try a new, more complex sheet next time.

Materials: Numbered dot-to-dot sheets (large print) · Pencil



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Origami Boat

OBJECTIVE

Follow multi-step instructions and develop precise folding technique through origami.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place a square of origami paper on the table, coloured side down.
2. Fold in half from top to bottom — crease firmly.
3. Fold the top corners down to meet the centre fold — you now have a triangle.
4. Fold the bottom flap up on both sides to form the hull of the boat.
5. Open the base gently and flatten to complete the boat shape. Place on the table and admire!

Materials: Square paper (at least 15 × 15 cm) · Step-by-step picture guide



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Puzzle Peg Placement

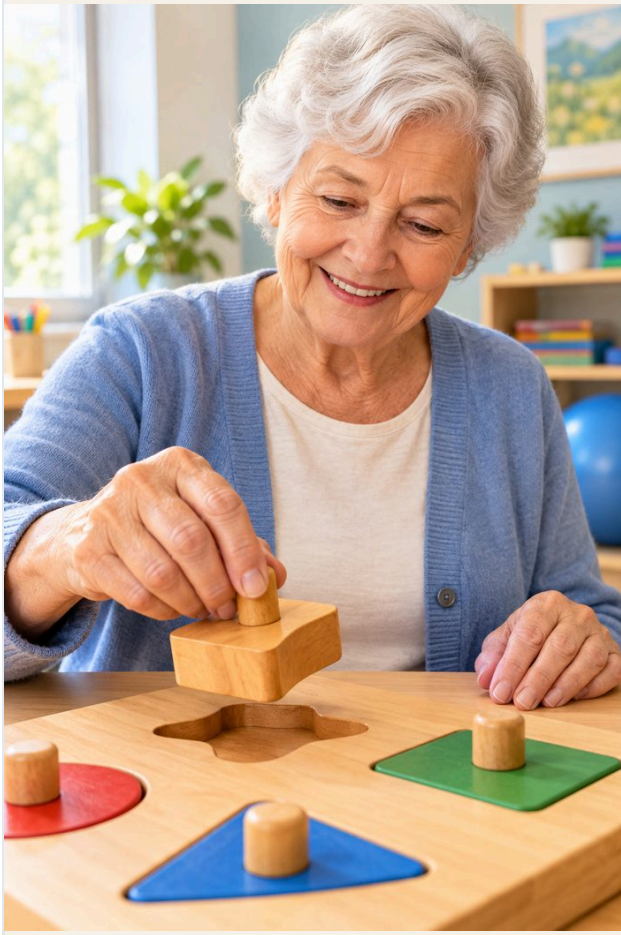
OBJECTIVE

Match shapes visually and practise accurate placement using chunky pegged puzzle pieces.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay the peg puzzle board on the table and tip all pieces out.
2. Sort the pieces by colour or shape.
3. Pick up one piece using the peg on top and identify its matching outline on the board.
4. Lower the piece into its correct space — it should fit without forcing.
5. Complete the full puzzle, remove all pieces, mix them up and try again. Time yourself for a challenge.

Materials: Chunky wooden peg puzzle board



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Finger Painting



OBJECTIVE

Promote tactile exploration and creative expression while exercising all finger joints.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Cover the table with a plastic sheet or newspaper. Set out washable paints and a large paper.
2. Dip one fingertip into the first colour and dab or streak it onto the paper.
3. Use different fingers for different colours — experiment with swirling, dotting and pressing.
4. Make a simple scene: a sun with yellow fingertips, grass with green palms, flowers with pink fingerprints.
5. When finished, wash hands immediately. Display the artwork proudly.

Materials: Washable finger paints (3–4 colours) · Large paper · Plastic cover · Paper towels

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.



SECTION 5 OF 6

Ball & Sport Games

24 exercises

Seated Bowling



OBJECTIVE

Encourage upper-body movement and competitive fun through adapted indoor bowling.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set up 6 lightweight pins (plastic bottles or skittles) in a triangle formation 2 metres away.
2. Participants sit in a row, each with a soft rubber ball.
3. Take turns rolling the ball along the floor with an underarm push to knock down the pins.
4. Count how many pins are knocked down per turn. Set up pins between each turn.
5. Play 3 rounds, recording scores. Adjust distance to match ability.

Materials: 6 lightweight pins or plastic bottles · Soft rubber ball per lane

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Balloon Tap Relay



OBJECTIVE

Develop upper-body coordination and teamwork through a keep-the-balloon-up relay.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Inflate one balloon per team of 4–5 participants seated in a row.
2. The first participant taps the balloon upward toward the next participant.
3. Each person taps it once only before it must move along the line.
4. If the balloon touches the floor, restart from participant one.
5. Count how many taps the team completes in 2 minutes. Compete between two teams or beat a team record.

Materials: 1 inflated balloon per team

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Catch & Name

OBJECTIVE

Combine physical catching with verbal cognitive tasks for a dual-function group activity.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Participants sit in a circle. The facilitator chooses a category (e.g. 'fruits').
2. The facilitator throws the ball to a participant.
3. That person must catch the ball and name one item in the category before passing it on.
4. Pass the ball around the circle — each person names a different item.
5. Change the category every 5 minutes. If someone cannot name an item, they choose the next category.

Materials: Soft ball · Chairs arranged in a circle



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Parachute Games

OBJECTIVE

Build teamwork, upper-body strength and coordination through group parachute play.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Spread the parachute out flat and have participants hold the edge at regular intervals.
2. On the count of 3, everyone lifts the parachute overhead to create a mushroom shape.
3. Lower it slowly together for a billow effect.
4. Add a ball to the top and try to keep it rolling in circles by rippling the parachute.
5. Vary with: waves, colour-call (run under when your colour is called), or mushroom and sit inside.

Materials: Large group parachute · 1–2 foam balls



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Bocce Ball



OBJECTIVE

Develop spatial judgment and arm control through precision underarm ball rolling.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Roll the small white pallino ball 2–3 metres onto the playing area.
2. Each participant rolls 2 coloured bocce balls, aiming as close to the pallino as possible.
3. Measure which ball is closest — that player scores 1 point per ball closer than the opponent's nearest ball.
4. Collect all balls and roll the pallino again to start the next round.
5. Play to 7 points. Adapt distances for ability — seated players roll from a lower position.

Materials: Bocce ball set (pallino + coloured balls) · Smooth playing surface

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Skittles

OBJECTIVE

Practise underarm rolling accuracy in a fun, competitive group game.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set 10 plastic skittles in a triangle 1.5–2 metres from the throwing line.
2. Give each participant 2 balls per turn.
3. Roll the first ball underarm along the floor to knock down as many skittles as possible.
4. Roll the second ball at any remaining standing skittles.
5. Record the number knocked down. Take turns and tally scores over 3 rounds.

Materials: 10 plastic skittles · 2 soft balls per player



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Football

OBJECTIVE

Improve lower-limb strength and coordination through adapted seated kicking.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Seat participants in a circle with two cones in the centre as mini goals.
2. Roll a foam ball between players — participants use feet only to control it.
3. Score by kicking the ball between the central cones.
4. A facilitator acts as referee and keeps the ball from going outside the circle.
5. Play 5-minute rounds, switching goalkeepers each round.

Materials: Foam ball · 2 cones for goals · Circle of chairs



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Over-Under Ball Pass

OBJECTIVE

Promote spinal mobility and teamwork through alternating overhead and under-knee passing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Seat participants in a row or circle, each sitting tall.
2. The first person passes the ball overhead to the person behind (or to their right).
3. That person passes it forward under their knees to the next.
4. Alternate: over-head, under-knees, over-head, under-knees down the line.
5. Time how fast the ball travels down the line and back. Try to beat the record.

Materials: Medium soft ball



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Noodle Jousting



OBJECTIVE

Build arm strength and timing through playful, gentle contact with foam pool noodles.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Seat two participants facing each other at arm's length.
2. Each holds one foam pool noodle horizontally with both hands.
3. On the count of 3, each gently taps their noodle against the other's noodle.
4. The aim is to tap the opponent's noodle downward or sideways — no jabbing at the person.
5. Play best of 5 rounds, then swap partners. Emphasise gentle contact and laughter over competition.

Materials: 1 foam pool noodle per participant · Seated arrangement

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Tossing Ring Quoits

OBJECTIVE

Build arm swing control and target accuracy through ring toss at varying distances.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set up a peg board or post targets at 1 metre, 1.5 metres and 2 metres.
2. Give each participant 5 rubber rings.
3. Toss each ring underarm, aiming for the nearest peg first.
4. Score 3 points for the furthest peg, 2 for the middle, 1 for the nearest.
5. Tally scores over 3 rounds. Adjust distances to match ability.

Materials: Quoits set (5 rings per player) · Peg board or posts



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Darts — Velcro

OBJECTIVE

Improve arm extension, aim and hand–eye coordination through safe velcro dart throwing.

INSTRUCTIONS

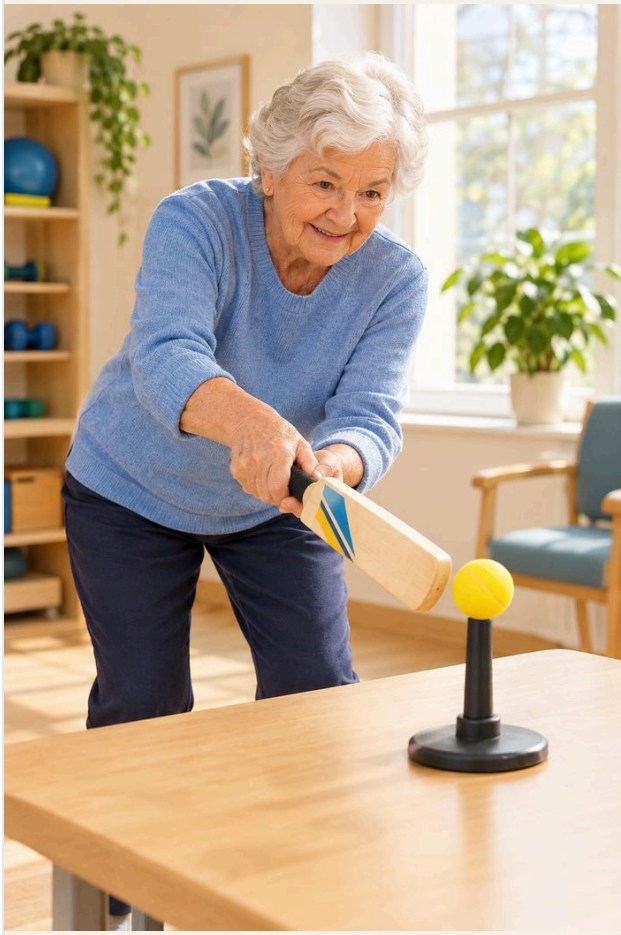
1. Mount the velcro dart board at eye height when seated (approximately 90 cm).
2. Mark a throwing line 1–1.5 metres from the board.
3. Give each participant 3 velcro-tipped darts.
4. Throw each dart underarm toward the board, aiming for the highest-scoring rings.
5. Tally each round's score. Play to 50 points or best of 5 rounds.

Materials: Velcro dart set (board + darts) · Wall mounting or stand



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Tabletop Cricket



OBJECTIVE

Encourage hand–eye coordination, timing and gentle competition through adapted cricket.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Place the table cricket set on a table. Set the ball on the tee.
2. The batter uses a short-handled bat to strike the ball off the tee.
3. Fielders catch or collect the ball and roll it back.
4. Score runs by hitting into designated zones marked on the table.
5. Play 6 balls per innings per participant. Tally scores across the group.

Materials: Table cricket set (bat, tee, ball, scoring mat)

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Basketball

OBJECTIVE

Develop overhead throwing strength and aim through adapted basketball shooting.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Adjust the ring or basket to a height reachable from seated (60–80 cm above seat).
2. Seat participants in a row 1–2 metres from the basket.
3. Give each participant 3 foam balls per turn.
4. Toss each ball overhead with both hands, aiming for the basket.
5. Score 1 point per basket. Play 3 rounds, tracking scores and adjusting distance for success.

Materials: Adjustable mini basketball ring · 3 foam balls per player



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Ball Pass Race

OBJECTIVE

Improve reaction speed and bilateral cooperation through rapid group ball passing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Seat participants in a circle. One person holds the ball.
2. On 'Go', pass the ball as quickly as possible around the circle in one direction.
3. Time how long it takes to complete one full circuit.
4. Try to beat the time on the next round.
5. Vary the direction, use two balls simultaneously, or add a rule (e.g. left hand only).

Materials: 1–2 medium soft balls · Timer



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Badminton



OBJECTIVE

Improve upper-body coordination and reaction through adapted seated racket play.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Give each participant a short-handled badminton racket and a shuttlecock.
2. Seat two players facing each other 1.5–2 metres apart.
3. Strike the shuttlecock gently toward your partner using an upward forehand hit.
4. The partner returns it in the same controlled manner.
5. Count consecutive rallies without the shuttlecock falling. Aim to improve the rally count.

Materials: Short-handled badminton rackets · Shuttlecock

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Colour Target Toss

OBJECTIVE

Develop visual targeting and upper-limb extension through colour-coded beanbag throwing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay 4 colour-coded target squares (or hula hoops) on the floor at 1–2 metres.
2. Give each participant 4 beanbags matching the target colours.
3. Call a colour and the participant tosses the matching beanbag underarm toward that target.
4. Score 1 point per beanbag landing in or touching the correct colour.
5. Play for 3 rounds, increasing the throw distance as accuracy improves.

Materials: 4 coloured beanbags per player · 4 colour-coded targets on floor



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Goalpost Kick

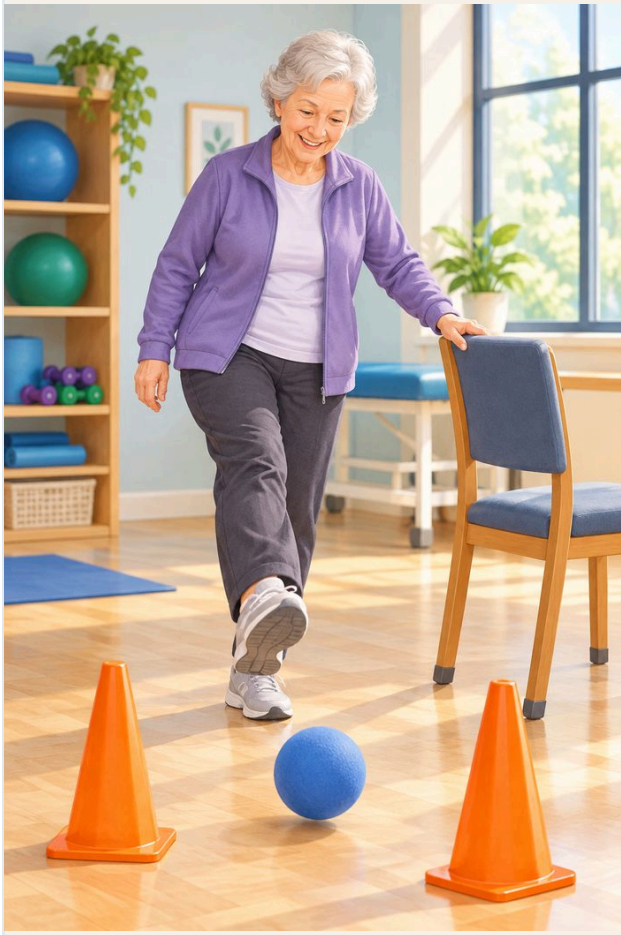
OBJECTIVE

Improve standing balance, lower-limb strength and kicking coordination.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set two cones 60 cm apart as goalposts, 1.5 metres from the kicking line.
2. Stand at the line, holding a wall or chair for balance.
3. Place the foam ball at your foot.
4. Kick the ball firmly between the goalposts using your right foot.
5. Retrieve the ball, return to the line, and kick with your left foot. Score 5 kicks per foot.

Materials: 2 cones · Foam ball · Wall or chair for support · Non-slip footwear



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Scoop Ball

OBJECTIVE

Improve hand–eye tracking and wrist control through catching and flicking with a scoop.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Give each participant a plastic catching scoop.
2. Sit or stand facing a partner 1.5 metres away.
3. The partner gently tosses a foam ball toward you.
4. Catch the ball in the scoop by moving the scoop under the ball as it falls.
5. Flick the ball back to your partner using an underarm wrist motion. Rally for 2 minutes then swap partners.

Materials: Plastic catching scoops (1 per participant) · Foam ball per pair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Hockey Seated

OBJECTIVE

Develop wrist and forearm control through tabletop stick and puck play.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Set up a tabletop surface with two small goal frames (books or blocks work) at each end.
2. Give each player a short-handled stick (or ruler) and place a soft puck in the centre.
3. Players use the stick to push the puck toward the opponent's goal.
4. Score 1 point per goal. Restart from the centre after each goal.
5. Play for 3 minutes per pair, then swap opponents.

Materials: 2 short-handled sticks or rulers · Soft puck or beanbag · Tabletop goals



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Team Keep-Away

OBJECTIVE

Promote strategic play, upper-body coordination and teamwork through balloon defence.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Divide participants into two teams seated in a large circle.
2. Each team occupies one half of the circle.
3. Inflate 1–2 balloons per team.
4. Each team tries to keep their balloon in the air within their half — opponents try to bat it to the floor.
5. Play for 3 minutes per round. Score 1 point each time the opposing team's balloon hits the floor.

Materials: 2 inflated balloons · Chairs in a large circle



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Croquet Mallet



OBJECTIVE

Build standing balance, spatial judgment and arm swing through adapted indoor croquet.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay wickets (bent wire arches) in a course on the floor.
2. Give each participant a foam croquet mallet.
3. Stand behind the starting line and swing the mallet gently to push the ball through the first wicket.
4. Follow the ball and continue swinging it through each wicket in order.
5. Count the number of swings needed to complete the course. Lower scores win.

Materials: Foam croquet set (mallet, balls, wickets) · Clear floor space

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Cup Ball Catch

OBJECTIVE

Develop hand–eye coordination and spatial tracking through catching in an oversized cup.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Give each participant a wide-mouthed plastic cup (at least 10 cm diameter).
2. A partner stands 1 metre away and tosses a small foam ball underarm toward the cup.
3. The catcher moves their cup under the ball and catches it.
4. After 5 successful catches, increase the toss distance by 30 cm.
5. Play for 3 rounds and count total catches. Swap tosser and catcher roles.

Materials: Wide-mouthed plastic cup per participant · Small foam balls



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Ball Relay Race

OBJECTIVE

Promote standing balance and lateral thinking through creative ball-passing relay.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Divide into teams of 4 standing in a row with space between each person.
2. Choose a body part rule: 'between knees', 'under chin', or 'elbow to elbow'.
3. The first player holds the ball in the specified way and passes it to the next player.
4. No hands allowed once the ball is in the body-part position.
5. Time the relay from first to last player. Drop = restart from that position. Play 3 rounds.

Materials: Medium ball per team · Open floor space · Stopwatch



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Seated Tennis

OBJECTIVE

Develop racket coordination, tracking and competitive play through adapted table tennis.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Lay a low net (tape or a line of books) across the centre of a large table.
2. Give each player a paddle (or book) and place a foam ball on the table.
3. Players sit at opposite ends and take turns hitting the ball over the net.
4. The ball must bounce once before the opponent returns it.
5. Play best of 7 points per game. Serve alternates every 2 points.

Materials: 2 paddles (or books) · Low net · Foam ball · Large table



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.



SECTION 6 OF 6

Breathing & Relaxation

24 exercises

Box Breathing

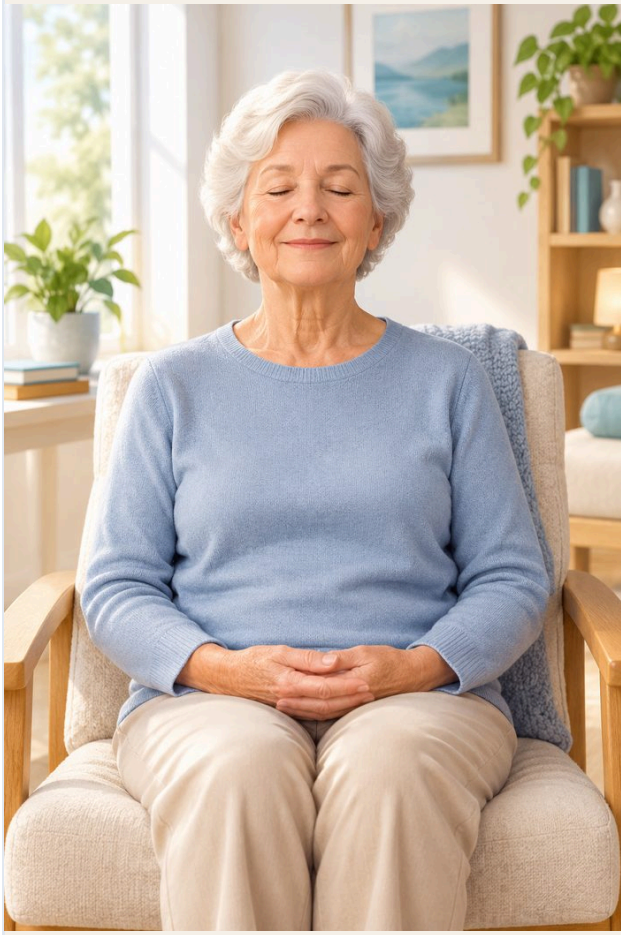
OBJECTIVE

Calm the nervous system and reduce anxiety through a structured 4-4-4-4 breathing pattern.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat and hands resting in your lap.
2. Breathe in slowly through your nose while counting to 4.
3. Hold your breath gently while counting to 4.
4. Breathe out slowly through your mouth while counting to 4.
5. Hold your breath gently again for a count of 4. This completes one box. Repeat 5 times.

Materials: No equipment required · Quiet room preferred



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Progressive Muscle Relax

OBJECTIVE

Release physical tension from head to toe through a systematic tense-and-release sequence.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably or lie down. Close your eyes and take 3 slow deep breaths.
2. Start at your feet: tense all the muscles in your feet and toes tightly for 5 seconds.
3. Release completely and notice the sensation of relaxation for 10 seconds.
4. Move upward: calves, thighs, abdomen, hands, arms, shoulders, face — tense each for 5 seconds, then release.
5. End with your whole body relaxed. Rest for 2 minutes before standing.

Materials: Comfortable chair or mat · Quiet room



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Belly Breathing

OBJECTIVE

Activate the diaphragm for deeper, more efficient breathing and immediate stress relief.

INSTRUCTIONS

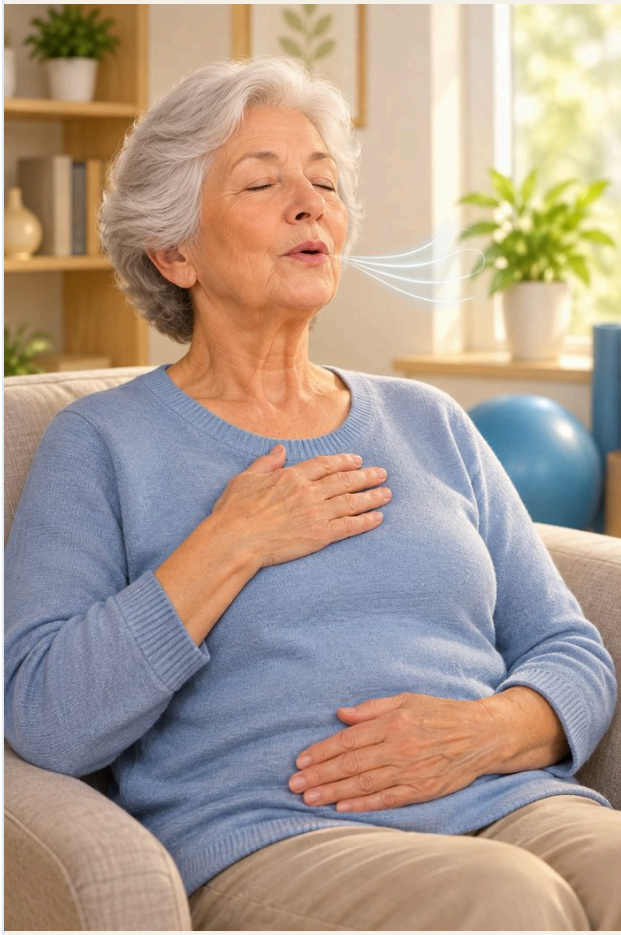
1. Sit or lie comfortably and place one hand on your chest and one hand on your belly.
2. Breathe in slowly through your nose for 4 counts.
3. As you breathe in, allow your belly to rise — your chest should remain mostly still.
4. Breathe out through your mouth for 6 counts, feeling your belly fall.
5. Continue for 8–10 breaths. The belly-hand should move; the chest-hand should barely move.

Materials: No equipment required · Comfortable chair



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Counted Exhale



OBJECTIVE

Slow the heart rate and calm the mind by extending the exhalation beyond the inhalation.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright with feet flat and hands in your lap.
2. Take a comfortable breath in through your nose for 3 counts.
3. Begin your exhale through slightly parted lips, counting slowly to 6.
4. Try to extend your exhale to 7 or 8 on the next breath without straining.
5. Continue for 10 breaths. The extended exhale activates the parasympathetic rest response.

Materials: No equipment required

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Pursed-Lip Breathing

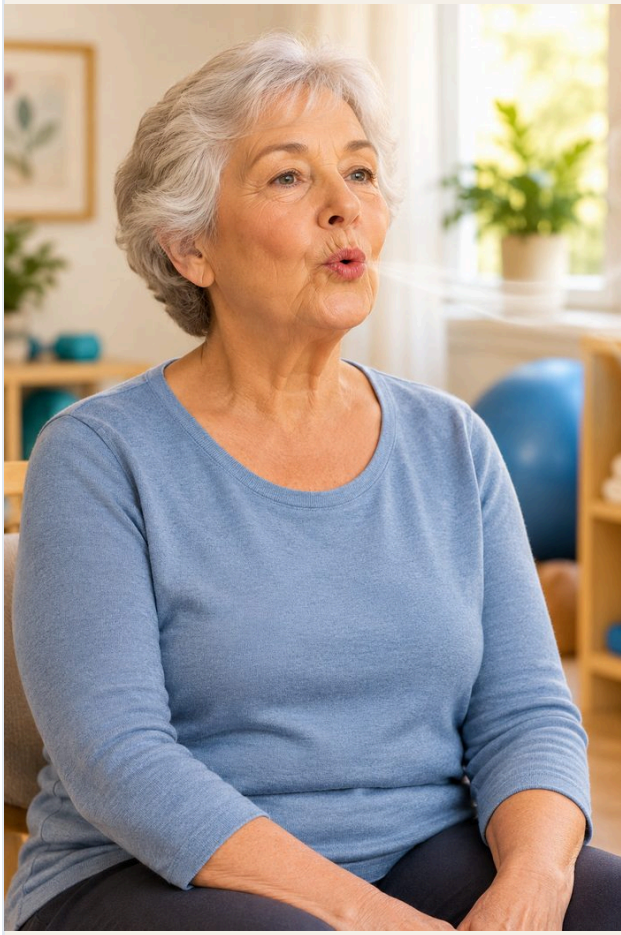
OBJECTIVE

Slow breathing rate, reduce breathlessness and improve oxygen exchange for those with lung conditions.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with shoulders relaxed.
2. Relax your neck and shoulder muscles.
3. Breathe in slowly through your nose for 2 counts — do not sniff, just breathe normally.
4. Pucker your lips as if you were going to whistle or blow out a candle.
5. Breathe out slowly through pursed lips for 4 counts. The exhale should be twice as long as the inhale. Repeat 10 times.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Sighing Exhale

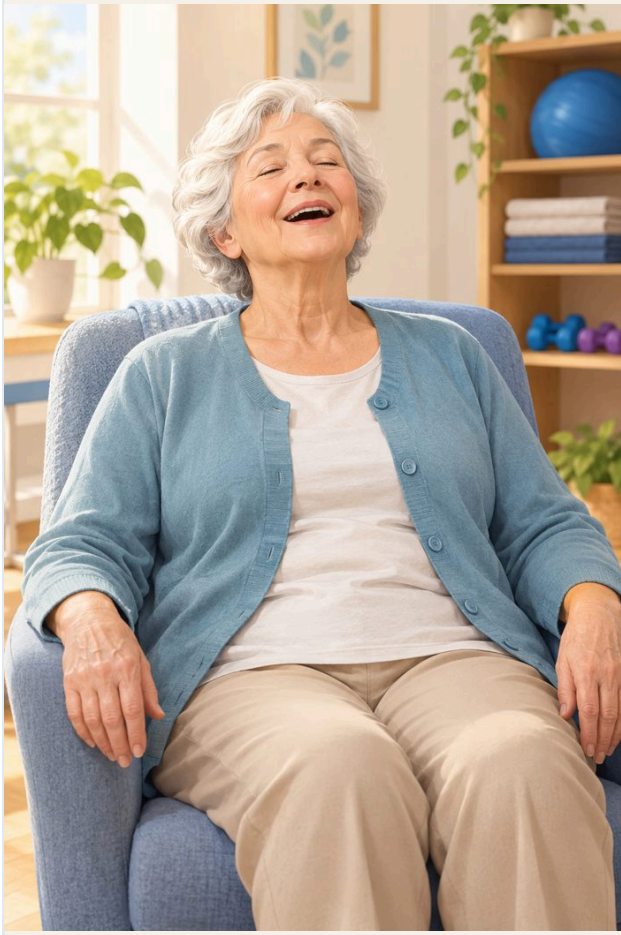
OBJECTIVE

Release accumulated physical tension through the natural stress-relief mechanism of sighing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably with hands in your lap and eyes softly closed.
2. Take a slow, full breath in through your nose, expanding your lungs completely.
3. At the top of your breath, pause for one moment.
4. Open your mouth and release the breath all at once with a natural audible sigh.
5. Let your shoulders drop and feel your muscles soften. Repeat 5 times, allowing tension to leave with each sigh.

Materials: No equipment required · Quiet room



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Alternate Nostril

OBJECTIVE

Balance the nervous system and improve focus through the yogic practice of nadi shodhana.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat. Rest your left hand on your left knee.
2. Raise your right hand: rest your index and middle fingers on your forehead, thumb near your right nostril, ring finger near your left.
3. Close your right nostril with your thumb. Breathe in through your left nostril for 4 counts.
4. Close both nostrils briefly, then open the right. Breathe out through your right nostril for 4 counts.
5. Breathe in through the right, close both, open left, breathe out left. That is one cycle. Repeat 5 cycles.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Guided Body Scan



OBJECTIVE

Develop mindful body awareness and deep relaxation through facilitated attention practice.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Participants sit or lie comfortably. Facilitator speaks in a slow, calm voice throughout.
2. Guide attention to the feet: 'Notice your feet... any sensations, warmth, pressure... breathe and relax them.'
3. Move slowly upward: calves, knees, thighs, hips, abdomen, chest, hands, arms, shoulders, neck, face.
4. Spend 30–45 seconds on each area, inviting relaxation with each exhale.
5. End with: 'Take a breath in... and when you are ready, gently open your eyes.' Allow quiet sitting for 1 minute.

Materials: Comfortable chairs or mats · Quiet room · Optional: soft relaxation music

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Balloon Blow

OBJECTIVE

Strengthen the respiratory muscles and improve breath control through sustained exhalation.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Give each participant an uninflated balloon.
2. Take a full breath in through the nose.
3. Place the balloon opening over your lips and blow steadily, watching the balloon grow.
4. Take another breath and continue blowing until the balloon is palm-sized.
5. Let the air out slowly and repeat 3–5 times. Alternatively, blow through a straw to move a cotton ball across a table.

Materials: Balloons or straws · Cotton balls (for straw version)



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Candle Breathing



OBJECTIVE

Practise controlled, sustained exhalation — a key breathing skill for singing, speech and lung health.

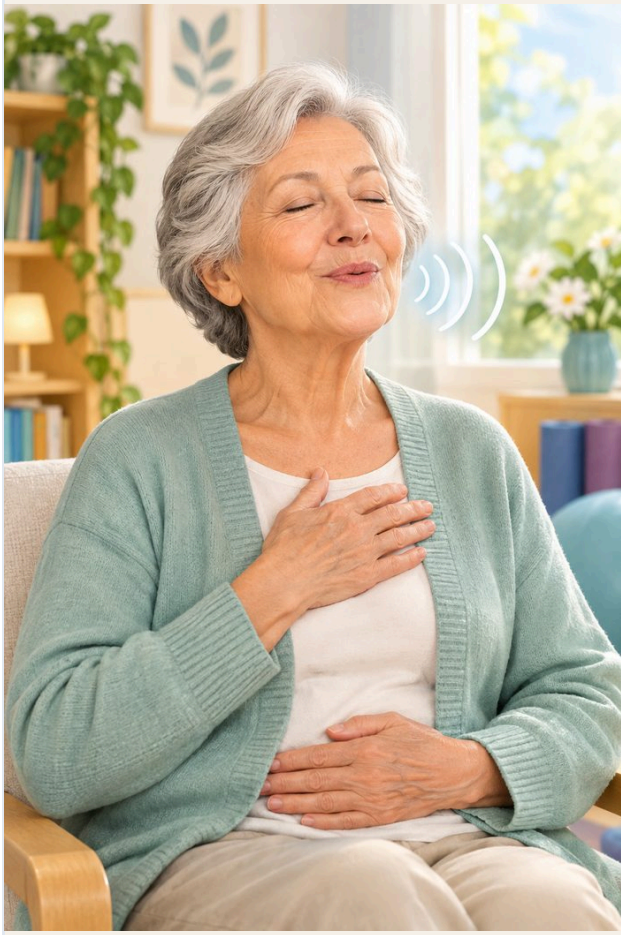
INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall. Hold up your index finger in front of your lips like a birthday candle.
2. Take a slow breath in through your nose for 3 counts.
3. Breathe out through pursed lips, very gently, as if trying to dim the 'candle' without blowing it out.
4. Aim to exhale steadily for 6–8 counts — the 'flame' flickers but stays lit.
5. Repeat 8 times. If using a real candle, maintain a safe distance and have water nearby.

Materials: No equipment required (optional: real birthday candle with holder)

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Humming Breath



OBJECTIVE

Extend the exhalation and produce calming vibrations through humming on the breath out.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat and eyes gently closed.
2. Take a comfortable breath in through your nose.
3. Close your lips softly and hum any tone on your exhale — feel the vibration in your lips and chest.
4. Try to sustain the hum for 5–8 seconds before taking another breath.
5. Continue for 8–10 breath cycles. You may notice a calming sensation — this is normal and beneficial.

Materials: No equipment required

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

4-7-8 Breathing



OBJECTIVE

Reduce anxiety and promote sleep through a structured breath-hold pattern that calms the nervous system.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit upright with the tip of your tongue touching the ridge behind your upper front teeth.
2. Exhale completely through your mouth, making a whoosh sound.
3. Close your mouth and inhale quietly through your nose for a count of 4.
4. Hold your breath for a count of 7.
5. Exhale completely through your mouth with a whoosh for a count of 8. This is one cycle. Repeat 4 cycles.

Materials: No equipment required · Quiet setting

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★ Independent

Sound-Bath Listen

OBJECTIVE

Induce deep relaxation and mindfulness through passive listening to resonant sound vibrations.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Seat participants comfortably with feet flat and hands in laps.
2. Invite them to close their eyes or soften their gaze.
3. Strike a singing bowl or chime slowly — allow the sound to fade completely before striking again.
4. Participants simply listen: notice the sound arising, the vibration, and the silence after.
5. Continue for 5–10 minutes. End with a gentle verbal cue to return attention to the room.

Materials: Singing bowl or set of chimes · Mallet · Quiet room



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Mindful Posture Check



OBJECTIVE

Cultivate present-moment awareness through a deliberate scan of seated body position.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit wherever you are and take one slow breath.
2. Notice your feet — are they flat on the floor? Adjust gently if not.
3. Notice your hands — are they tense? Relax them in your lap, palms upward.
4. Notice your shoulders — are they raised or forward? Roll them back and let them drop.
5. Finally, chin — is it tucked or jutting forward? Bring it gently level. Breathe and stay still for 60 seconds.

Materials: No equipment required

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Nature Sound Relaxation

OBJECTIVE

Reduce physiological stress markers through immersive listening to natural ambient soundscapes.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Dim the lights and seat participants comfortably. Have them remove glasses and close eyes.
2. Play a nature soundscape — rain, forest, ocean waves or birdsong — at a calm, moderate volume.
3. Invite participants to breathe slowly and let their attention rest on the sounds.
4. Guide gently: 'You might imagine yourself in this place... feeling the air... fully at rest.'
5. After 5 minutes, gradually raise the lights and guide everyone back with 3 slow deep breaths.

Materials: Speaker · Nature soundscape recording · Dimmer or soft lighting



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Warm-Hands Visualisation



OBJECTIVE

Improve peripheral circulation and relaxation through guided thermal imagery and breath.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably and rub both palms together briskly for 10 seconds until they feel warm.
2. Cup your warm hands over your closed eyes, fingers pointing upward.
3. Breathe slowly and visualise a warm, golden light radiating from your palms into your eyes and face.
4. Hold this position for 30–60 seconds, breathing steadily.
5. Lower your hands, blink gently, and notice any sensation of warmth or relaxation in your face.

Materials: No equipment required · Quiet room

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Stretch and Sigh



OBJECTIVE

Pair movement with breath to release tension and re-energise in a single flowing motion.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with feet flat and arms relaxed at your sides.
2. Breathe in slowly and raise both arms out to the sides and overhead.
3. At the top, reach fingertips toward the ceiling and feel a full-body stretch.
4. Open your mouth and exhale with a full, audible sigh as you lower your arms slowly.
5. Let your shoulders drop completely. Repeat 5 times, each sigh releasing a little more tension.

Materials: No equipment required

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Colour-Breathing

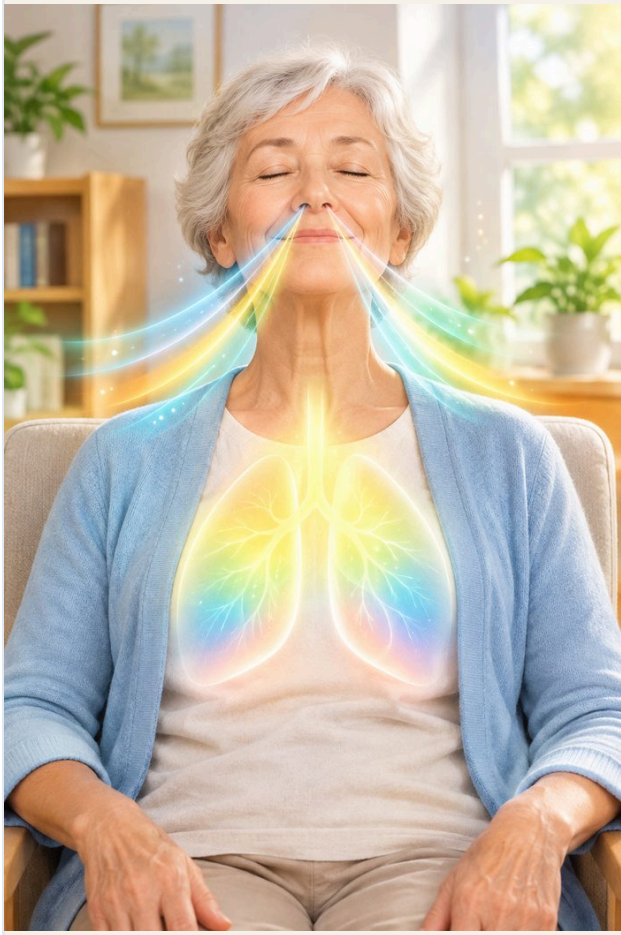
OBJECTIVE

Use creative visualisation to deepen the relaxation response during mindful breathing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably and close your eyes.
2. Choose a calming colour that feels soothing to you — blue, green or soft pink work well.
3. As you breathe in, visualise breathing in that colour as a gentle mist filling your body.
4. As you breathe out, visualise breathing out a muddy grey mist — tension and stress leaving.
5. Repeat for 10 breaths. With each cycle, the colour inside grows richer and the outgoing grey becomes lighter.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Gentle Self-Massage

OBJECTIVE

Relieve tension and improve circulation through simple hand-applied pressure on key areas.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit comfortably. Rub your palms together for 10 seconds to generate warmth.
2. With both hands, glide firmly from wrists to elbows along the forearms — 5 strokes each arm.
3. Use both hands to squeeze and release the muscles across the top of each shoulder — 5 squeezes.
4. With fingertips, make small circles at the base of your skull — 10 slow circles.
5. Finish by cupping your hands over your face and breathing into the warmth for 5 slow breaths.

Materials: No equipment required



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

★★★ Supported

Chair Yoga Nidra



OBJECTIVE

Guide participants into a deeply restful state between waking and sleep using a 20-minute body-awareness script.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Seat participants in the most comfortable position possible — feet flat, hands in lap, eyes closed.
2. Begin with 5 minutes of slow abdominal breathing to settle the nervous system.
3. Slowly guide awareness through the body in sequence: right side from toes to fingertips, then left side, then front body, then back body.
4. Invite participants to repeat a sankalpa (personal intention) silently 3 times at the midpoint.
5. Conclude by counting from 10 to 1, instructing participants to become increasingly aware of the room before opening their eyes.

Materials: Comfortable chairs · Blankets optional · Quiet room · Facilitator script

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Breathing Beads

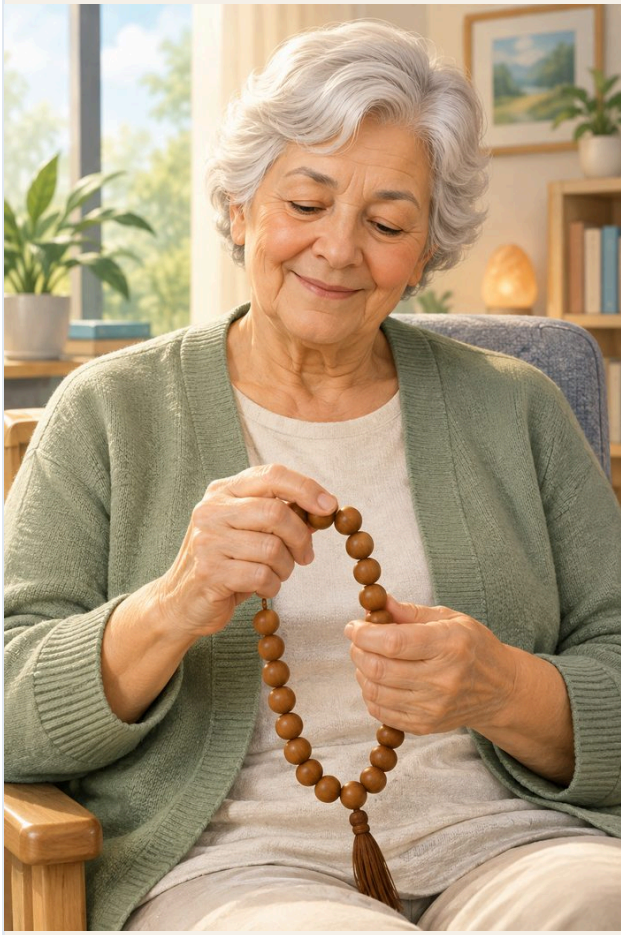
OBJECTIVE

Combine tactile focus with slow breathing to anchor attention and reduce anxiety.

INSTRUCTIONS

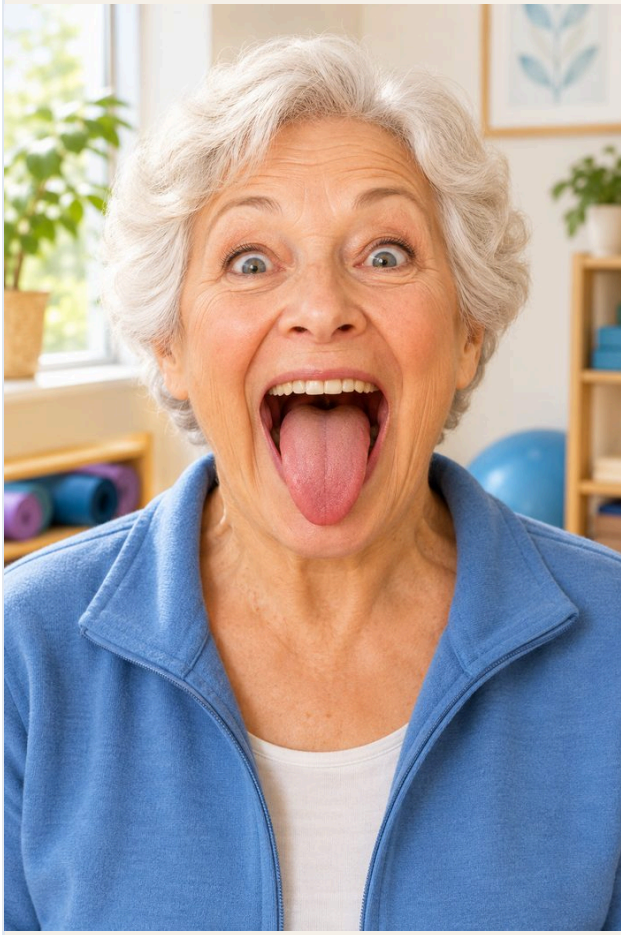
1. Thread 10 large beads onto a cord or use a meditation mala or rosary.
2. Hold the cord in your lap with one hand, first bead between thumb and index finger.
3. Take one slow, deep breath in and out completely.
4. Slide your thumb to the next bead.
5. Continue — one bead per complete breath — until all 10 beads have been counted. Rest, then repeat.

Materials: 10-bead cord, mala or rosary



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Lion Breath



OBJECTIVE

Release facial and jaw tension through an exaggerated exhale that also encourages group laughter.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit tall with hands on your knees and take a gentle breath in through your nose.
2. At the top of your breath, pause for a moment.
3. Open your mouth as wide as possible, stick out your tongue toward your chin, and exhale with a 'HAAA' sound.
4. At the same time, open your eyes wide and look slightly upward.
5. Return to neutral, breathe normally for 2 breaths, then repeat 5 times. Expect and welcome laughter!

Materials: No equipment required

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Laughing Breath

OBJECTIVE

Trigger the physiological benefits of laughter — reduced cortisol and increased endorphins — through intentional laughing.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Sit in a circle. The facilitator begins by fake-laughing on the exhale: 'ha-ha-ha-ha'.
2. Each exhale is a laughter sound — 'ha-ha' or 'ho-ho' or 'hee-hee'.
3. Participants join in one by one, fake-laughing on every exhale.
4. Within 30–60 seconds, genuine laughter usually replaces the fake version.
5. Allow the laughter to continue naturally for 1–2 minutes, then sit quietly and notice the after-effects.

Materials: No equipment required · Group setting recommended



Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.

Cool-Down Sequence



OBJECTIVE

Safely return the body to a resting state after activity through a structured closing routine.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Begin with 5 slow neck side stretches — left ear, right ear, chin down, look right, look left.
2. Roll both shoulders backward 5 times, then shrug and release 3 times.
3. Circle both wrists clockwise 5 times, then anticlockwise 5 times.
4. Circle both ankles slowly 5 times in each direction.
5. Finish with 3 deep belly breaths: in for 4 counts, hold 2, out for 6. Sit still for 30 seconds.

Materials: No equipment required

Tip for facilitators: Encourage participants to keep their back straight and breathe steadily. Stop if any discomfort arises.